

Frankenstein

Mary Shelley · 1818

1831 revised edition (with the 1818 Preface)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

30 chapter lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 35 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 7 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–30), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: The reading text is Mary Shelley's revised 1831 edition (Standard Ebooks, from Project Gutenberg #42324), which also prints the 1818 Preface and the 1831 Introduction. In 1818 Elizabeth is Victor's cousin; in 1831 she is the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, adopted by Victor's mother. Chapter breaks also differ (e.g. around Chapter III). Cite this edition.

Content note for teachers: The novel includes suicide, the murder of a child, a wrongful execution and the murder of a bride; see the chapter notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these novels are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 7. **Class days:** 35 × 90 minutes (30 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Frankenstein suggest about the costs of unchecked ambition?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about creation and responsibility?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about isolation and the need for companionship?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about nature versus nurture?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about the sublime power of nature?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE
- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

Primary codes: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80

8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	Introduction Preface Letter I Letter II Letter III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	*Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition* Letter IV Chapter I Chapter II Chapter III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Chapter IV Chapter V Chapter VI Chapter VII Chapter VIII	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*isolation and the need for companionship* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Chapter IX *Socratic seminar on creation and responsibility* Chapter X Chapter XI Chapter XII	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*nature versus nurture* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on creation and responsibility • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Chapter XIII Chapter XIV Chapter XV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the sublime power of nature* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket,	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	Chapter XVI Chapter XVII		closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	
6	Chapter XVIII Chapter XIX *Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship* Chapter XX Chapter XXI	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
7	Chapter XXII Chapter XXIII Chapter XXIV *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final essay workshop and submission*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction

Focus: the origin of the novel and the idea of creation

Teacher only · spoilers

Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book her 'hideous progeny.'

Background: The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation.

Significance: The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are platitude, invocations, retrospection, galvanism, beatings. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task." In this sentence it means: dullness; a lack of freshness or originality. Word histories: "galvanism": Named after Luigi Galvani (1737–1798), the Bologna anatomist who made dead frogs' legs twitch with electric current; galvanism meant electricity produced by chemical action. For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation. Why does this chapter matter? The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? I circle "invocations", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find point of view, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for point of view.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task. One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart. If I did not accomplish these things, my ghost story would be unworthy of its name. I thought and pondered—vainly. I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations. Have you thought of a story? I was asked each morning, and each morning I was forced to reply with a mortifying negative.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Allusion, Imagery: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
platitude (noun)	dullness; a lack of freshness or originality	*The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invocations (noun)	calls or appeals for help or inspiration	*I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retrospection (noun)	looking back on the past	*Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
galvanism (noun)	electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	"galvanism": Named after Luigi Galvani (1737–1798), the Bologna anatomist who made dead frogs' legs twitch with electric current; galvanism meant electricity produced by chemical action. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/galvanism)
beatings (noun)	beats; throbs (of the heart)	*One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
reanimated (verb)	brought back to life or strength; revived	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

appertain (verb)	to belong to or be connected with	*In all matters of discovery and invention, even of those that appertain to the imagination, we are continually reminded of the story of Columbus and his egg.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cradled (verb)	held gently, as in a cradle	*The shape was lost beneath the shadow of the castle walls; but soon a gate swung back, a step was heard, the door of the chamber opened, and he advanced to the couch of the blooming youths, cradled in healthy sleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inciting (verb)	give an incentive for action	*He was forever inciting me to obtain literary reputation, which even on my own part I cared for then, though since I have become infinitely indifferent to it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
parquet (noun)	a wooden floor laid in a pattern	*I see them still; the very room, the dark parquet, the closed shutters, with the moonlight struggling through, and the sense I had that the glassy lake and white high Alps were beyond.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?
   A. In London
   B. In Venice
   C. On a ship to the Arctic
   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland

2. Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story?
   A. Lord Byron
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. Shelley's father
   D. Robert Walton
3. What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea?
   A. Galvanism and the principle of life
   B. Astronomy
   C. Steam engines
   D. Botany
4. How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley?
   A. While reading a play
   B. In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed
   C. In a letter from a friend
   D. From a newspaper story
5. What does Shelley call her book?
   A. Her little ghost
   B. Her Prometheus
   C. Her summer diary
   D. Her hideous progeny
6. In the line "The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.", what does "platitude" most nearly mean?
   A. looking back on the past
   B. calls or appeals for help or inspiration
   C. electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles
   D. dullness; a lack of freshness or originality
7. In the line "I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.", what does "invocations" most nearly mean?
   A. electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles
   B. calls or appeals for help or inspiration
   C. looking back on the past
   D. dullness; a lack of freshness or originality

Answer key: 1. D (Near Geneva, Switzerland); 2. A (Lord Byron); 3. A (Galvanism and the principle of life); 4. B (In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed); 5. D (Her hideous progeny); 6. D (dullness; a lack of freshness or originality); 7. B (calls or appeals for help or inspiration)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage

your teacher selects). In “Introduction,” how does Shelley show the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Introduction, how does Shelley develop the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Introduction (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Introduction suggests about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and allusion), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Introduction to complicate the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Introduction within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Introduction alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Introduction and

its treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and allusion, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Introduction as evidence for a larger claim about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Introduction as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “retrospection” most nearly mean?

   A. give an incentive for action

   B. a wooden floor laid in a pattern

   C. looking back on the past

   D. held gently, as in a cradle

2. *I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task. One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart. If I did not accomplish these things, my ghost story would be unworthy of its name. I thought and pondered—vainly. I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations. Have you thought of a story? I was asked each morning, and each morning I was forced to reply with a mortifying negative.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Introduction”?

   A. Language, knowledge and sorrow

   B. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

   C. Loss and leaving home

   D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. C (looking back on the past); 2. B (The origin of the novel and the idea of creation)

Lesson 2: Preface

Focus: the author's stated purpose

Teacher only · spoilers

The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.

Background: Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life.

Significance: The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are innovate, scrupled, spectres, environs, disadvantages. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations." In this sentence it means: to make changes; to introduce something new. Word histories: "scrupled": From Latin scrupulus "small sharp stone; uneasiness," the image of a pebble in one's shoe; the verb means "to hesitate on grounds of conscience." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life. Why does this chapter matter? The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for tone / mood.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the author's stated purpose? I circle "spectres", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find tone / mood, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of tone / mood. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence. I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors. The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment. It was recommended by the novelty of the situations which it develops; and, however impossible as a physical fact, affords a point of view to the imagination for the delineating of human passions more comprehensive and commanding than any which the ordinary relations of existing events can yield.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Tone / mood, Theme, Allusion: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the author's stated purpose, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how tone / mood shapes the author's stated purpose. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
innovate (verb)	to make changes; to introduce something new	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scrupled (verb)	hesitated because of a moral doubt	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	“scrupled”: From Latin scrupulus "small sharp stone; uneasiness," the image of a pebble in one's shoe; the verb means "to hesitate on grounds of conscience." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/scruple)
spectres (noun)	ghosts	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
environs (noun)	the area in which something exists or lives	*I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disadvantages (noun)	the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
elementary (adjective)	basic; fundamental	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ghostly (adjective)	resembling or characteristic of a phantom	*The weather, however, suddenly became serene; and my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory of their ghostly visions.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
weaving (verb)	interlace by or as if by weaving	*I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors.	
occurrence (noun)	an event that happens	*Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence.*	“occurrence”: From Latin occurrere "to run to meet," from ob- "toward" + currere "to run." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/occurrence)
expedient (noun)	a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one	*It was commenced partly as a source of amusement, and partly as an expedient for exercising any untried resources of mind.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion

Chapter quiz

1. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?
   A. Isaac Newton
   B. Galileo
   C. Humphry Davy
   D. Dr. Darwin
2. According to the Preface, what value does the story hope to display?
   A. The wealth of nations
   B. The glory of war
   C. The beauty of cities
   D. The amiableness of domestic affection
3. What kind of writing does the Preface compare the work to?
   A. Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays
   B. Cookbooks
   C. Newspaper reports

D. Sermons

4. What is the tone of the Preface?
   A. Angry and accusatory
   B. Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness
   C. Comic and mocking
   D. Romantic and lovesick
5. What season and weather does the Preface recall?
   A. A cold, rainy summer
   B. An autumn harvest
   C. A snowy winter in London
   D. A hot spring in Italy
6. In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “innovate” most nearly mean?
   A. to make changes; to introduce something new
   B. hesitated because of a moral doubt
   C. the area in which something exists or lives
   D. ghosts
7. In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “scrupled” most nearly mean?
   A. to make changes; to introduce something new
   B. ghosts
   C. the area in which something exists or lives
   D. hesitated because of a moral doubt

Answer key: 1. D (Dr. Darwin); 2. D (The amiableness of domestic affection); 3. A (Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays); 4. B (Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness); 5. A (A cold, rainy summer); 6. A (to make changes; to introduce something new); 7. D (hesitated because of a moral doubt)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Preface,” how does Shelley show the author's stated purpose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Preface, how does Shelley develop the idea of the author's stated purpose? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at

least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Preface (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Preface suggests about the author's stated purpose. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Preface to complicate the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Preface within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the author's stated purpose responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Preface alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the author's stated purpose follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Preface and its treatment of the author's stated purpose. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Preface as evidence for a larger claim about the author's stated purpose in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Preface as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the author's stated purpose. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "spectres" most nearly mean?

   A. interlace by or as if by weaving

   B. ghosts

   C. a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one

   D. an event that happens

2. *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence. I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors. The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment. It was recommended by the novelty of the situations which it develops; and, however impossible as a physical fact, affords a point of view to the imagination for the delineating of human passions more comprehensive and commanding than any which the ordinary relations of existing events can yield.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface"?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

   B. The first spark of obsession

   C. Confrontation between creator and creation

   D. The author's stated purpose

SAT key: 1. B (ghosts); 2. D (The author's stated purpose)

Lesson 3: Letter I

Focus: ambition and the hunger for discovery

Teacher only · spoilers

Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.

Background: Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel).

Significance: Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are enticement, fluctuate, effusions, satiate, foretaste. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path." In this sentence it means: something that tempts or attracts. Word histories: "fluctuate": From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel). Why does this chapter matter? Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to ambition and the hunger for discovery? I circle "forebodings", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find point of view, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for point of view.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday; and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare, and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Foreshadowing, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about ambition and the hunger for discovery, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes ambition and the hunger for discovery. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
enticement (noun)	something that tempts or attracts	*My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fluctuate (verb)	to rise and fall; to change often	*My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.*	"fluctuate": From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/fluctuate)
effusions (noun)	an unrestrained expression of emotion	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
satiate (verb)	fill to satisfaction	*I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited, and may tread a land never before imprinted by the foot of man.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
foretaste (noun)	an early limited awareness of something yet to occur	*This breeze, which has travelled from the regions towards which I am advancing, gives me a foretaste of those icy climes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
entranced (verb)	attract; cause to be enamored	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
diffusing (verb)	spreading out	*There, Margaret, the sun is forever visible; its broad disk just skirting the horizon, and diffusing a perpetual splendour.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sledges (noun)	a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow	*They fly quickly over the snow in their sledges; the motion is pleasant, and, in my opinion, far more agreeable than that of an English stagecoach.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
seafaring (adjective)	used on the high seas	*These volumes were my study day and night, and my familiarity with them increased that regret which I had felt, as a child, on learning that my*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		father's dying injunction had forbidden my uncle to allow me to embark in a seafaring life.	
forebodings (noun)	a feeling of evil to come	*You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. To whom is Walton writing?
   A. His sister, Margaret Saville
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. A ship's captain
   D. His father
2. Where is Walton when he writes the first letter?
   A. Archangel
   B. London
   C. Geneva
   D. St. Petersburg
3. What does Walton hope to discover?
   A. A cure for disease
   B. Gold in Siberia
   C. A lost city
   D. A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet
4. How did Walton educate himself as a boy?
   A. Attending university in Paris
   B. Working in a laboratory

C. Reading his uncle's library of voyages

D. Studying law

5. What does Walton's ambition foreshadow?

A. A war with Russia

B. Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge

C. A happy marriage

D. His return home rich

6. In the line “My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.”, what does “enticement” most nearly mean?

A. something that tempts or attracts

B. an unrestrained expression of emotion

C. to rise and fall; to change often

D. fill to satisfaction

7. In the line “My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.”, what does “fluctuate” most nearly mean?

A. an unrestrained expression of emotion

B. fill to satisfaction

C. to rise and fall; to change often

D. something that tempts or attracts

Answer key: 1. A (His sister, Margaret Saville); 2. D (St. Petersburg); 3. D (A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet); 4. C (Reading his uncle's library of voyages); 5. B (Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge); 6. A (something that tempts or attracts); 7. C (to rise and fall; to change often)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter I,” how does Shelley show ambition and the hunger for discovery? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Letter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Letter I

(where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Letter I suggests about ambition and the hunger for discovery. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Letter I to complicate the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of ambition and the hunger for discovery follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter I and its treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter I as evidence for a larger claim about ambition and the hunger for discovery in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*

As used in the text, what does the word "effusions" most nearly mean?

A. a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow

B. used on the high seas

C. a feeling of evil to come

D. an unrestrained expression of emotion

2. *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday; and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare, and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Letter I"?

A. The first death and growing guilt

B. Confidence before danger

C. Destroying the companion

D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. D (an unrestrained expression of emotion); 2. D (Ambition and the hunger for discovery)

Lesson 4: Letter II

Focus: loneliness and the desire for a friend

Teacher only · spoilers

From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, “I shall kill no albatross.”

Background: Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child.

Significance: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are albatross, embarkation, amassed, unemployed, endowments. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: “I am going to unexplored regions, to “the land of mist and snow”; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the “Ancient Mariner.”” In this sentence it means: a very large seabird of the southern oceans. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child. Why does this chapter matter? Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to loneliness and the desire for a friend? I circle "encompassed", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise. I have hired a vessel, and am occupied in collecting my sailors; those whom I have already engaged, appear to be men on whom I can depend, and are certainly possessed of dauntless courage.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about loneliness and the desire for a friend, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes loneliness and the desire for a friend. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
albatross (noun)	a very large seabird of the southern oceans	*I am going to unexplored regions, to "the land of mist and snow"; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the "Ancient Mariner."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
embarkation (noun)	going on board a ship to start a voyage	*Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
amassed (verb)	gathered or collected a large amount of	*Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unemployed (adjective)	not engaged in a gainful occupation	*I first became acquainted with him on board a whale vessel: finding that he was unemployed in this city, I easily engaged him to assist in my enterprise.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
endowments (noun)	natural abilities or qualities	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
illiterate (adjective)	poorly educated; unable to read well	*Now I am twenty-eight, and am in reality more illiterate than many schoolboys of fifteen.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
encompassed (verb)	surrounded	*How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retains (verb)	keeps	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mildness (noun)	gentleness	*The master is a person of an excellent disposition, and is remarkable in the ship for his gentleness and the mildness of his discipline.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
voyages (noun)	an act of traveling by water	*But it is a still greater evil to me that I am self-educated: for the first fourteen years of my life I ran wild on a common, and read nothing but our uncle Thomas's books of voyages.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Walton say he lacks most?
   A. A friend who shares his feelings
   B. A ship
   C. Money for the voyage
   D. Maps of the Arctic
2. Which poem does Walton allude to?
   A. The Iliad
   B. The Rime of the Ancient Mariner
   C. Hamlet
   D. Paradise Lost
3. From what port does Walton write this letter?
   A. Geneva
   B. Lisbon
   C. Archangel
   D. Ingolstadt
4. What theme is introduced by his longing?
   A. The love of money
   B. The evils of travel
   C. The joy of solitude
   D. The need for companionship
5. How does Walton describe his crew's master?
   A. A former pirate
   B. Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness
   C. Lazy and drunk
   D. Cruel and violent
6. In the line “I am going to unexplored regions, to “the land of mist and snow”; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the “Ancient Mariner.””, what does “albatross” most nearly mean?
   A. gathered or collected a large amount of
   B. not engaged in a gainful occupation
   C. going on board a ship to start a voyage
   D. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

7. In the line “Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.”, what does “embarkation” most nearly mean?

   A. gathered or collected a large amount of

   B. going on board a ship to start a voyage

   C. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

   D. not engaged in a gainful occupation

Answer key: 1. A (A friend who shares his feelings); 2. B (The Rime of the Ancient Mariner); 3. C (Archangel); 4. D (The need for companionship); 5. B (Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness); 6. D (a very large seabird of the southern oceans); 7. B (going on board a ship to start a voyage)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter II,” how does Shelley show loneliness and the desire for a friend? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Letter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Letter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Letter II suggests about loneliness and the desire for a friend. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Letter II to complicate the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loneliness and the desire for a friend follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter II and its treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter II as evidence for a larger claim about loneliness and the desire for a friend in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “amassed” most nearly mean?

   A. gentleness

   B. an act of traveling by water

   C. keeps

   D. gathered or collected a large amount of

2. *How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise. I have hired a vessel, and am occupied in collecting my sailors; those whom I have already engaged, appear to be men on whom I can depend, and are certainly possessed of dauntless courage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter II”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   D. A letter, a secret and the wedding

SAT key: 1. D (gathered or collected a large amount of); 2. C (Loneliness and the desire for a friend)

Lesson 5: Letter III

Focus: confidence before danger

Teacher only · spoilers

A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.

Background: Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction.

Significance: Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are pathless, tracing, indicating, homeward, incidents. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph." In this sentence it means: without paths; untraveled. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction. Why does this chapter matter? Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for tone / mood.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to confidence before danger? I circle "incidents", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find tone / mood, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of tone / mood. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter. One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Tone / mood, Foreshadowing, Setting: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about confidence before danger, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how tone / mood shapes confidence before danger. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pathless (adjective)	without paths; untraveled	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tracing (verb)	following the course of; marking out		

		Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.	Student look-up (not yet verified)
indicating (verb)	showing; pointing to	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
homeward (adjective)	oriented toward home	*This letter will reach England by a merchantman now on its homeward voyage from Archangel; more fortunate than I, who may not see my native land, perhaps, for many years.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
incidents (noun)	a single distinct event	*No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
accidents (noun)	an unfortunate mishap; especially one causing damage or injury	*One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
obedient (adjective)	dutifully complying with the commands or instructions of those in authority	*Why not still proceed over the untamed yet obedient element?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
floating (adjective)	drifting on water	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
prudent (adjective)	careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment	*I will be cool, persevering, and prudent.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
advancing (verb)	move forward, also in the metaphorical sense	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. How does Walton feel in Letter III?
   A. Ill and weak
   B. Confident and determined
   C. Ready to turn back
   D. Terrified
2. What danger does he mention seeing?
   A. Floating sheets of ice
   B. A pirate ship
   C. A whale attack
   D. A volcano
3. What is the main purpose of this letter?
   A. To announce his marriage
   B. To ask for money
   C. To reassure Margaret he is safe
   D. To describe Victor
4. What does Walton's confidence create for the reader?
   A. Dramatic irony and suspense
   B. Boredom
   C. Comedy
   D. Certainty of success
5. Which word best describes Walton's attitude?
   A. Defeated
   B. Resolute
   C. Regretful
   D. Indifferent
6. In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “pathless” most nearly mean?
   A. showing; pointing to
   B. oriented toward home
   C. following the course of; marking out
   D. without paths; untraveled

7. In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “tracing” most nearly mean?
   A. following the course of; marking out
   B. without paths; untraveled
   C. oriented toward home
   D. showing; pointing to

Answer key: 1. B (Confident and determined); 2. A (Floating sheets of ice); 3. C (To reassure Margaret he is safe); 4. A (Dramatic irony and suspense); 5. B (Resolute); 6. D (without paths; untraveled); 7. A (following the course of; marking out)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter III,” how does Shelley show confidence before danger? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Letter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of confidence before danger? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Letter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Letter III suggests about confidence before danger. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Letter III to complicate the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confidence before danger responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confidence before danger follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter III and its treatment of confidence before danger. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter III as evidence for a larger claim about confidence before danger in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confidence before danger. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “indicating” most nearly mean?

   A. showing; pointing to

   B. drifting on water

   C. careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment

   D. move forward, also in the metaphorical sense

2. *No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter. One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter III”?

   A. Loss and leaving home

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. Injustice and the burden of silence

   D. Confidence before danger

SAT key: 1. A (showing; pointing to); 2. D (Confidence before danger)

Lesson 6: Letter IV

Focus: the meeting of two ambitious men

Teacher only · spoilers

Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.

Background: The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative.

Significance: Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are capitulated, tutored, telescopes, rawness, eventual. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless." In this sentence it means: gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety). Word histories: "capitulated": From Medieval Latin capitulare "to draw up under headings," from capitulum "little head, chapter," from caput "head"; hence arranging terms, then surrendering on terms. For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "About two o'clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the meeting of two ambitious men? I circle "telescopes", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *About two o'clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end. Some of my comrades groaned, and my own mind began to grow watchful with anxious thoughts, when a strange sight suddenly attracted our attention, and diverted our solicitude from our own situation. We perceived a low carriage, fixed on a sledge and drawn by dogs, pass on towards the north, at the distance of half a mile: a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature, sat in the sledge, and guided the dogs. We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Point of view: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the meeting of two ambitious men, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the meeting of two ambitious men. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
capitulated (verb)	gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)	*Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.*	"capitulated": From Medieval Latin capitulare "to draw up under headings," from capitulum "little head, chapter," from caput "head"; hence arranging terms, then surrendering on terms. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/capitulate)
tutored (verb)	taught; educated	*You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
telescopes (noun)	instruments that make distant objects look closer	*We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rawness (noun)	cold, damp harshness	*He manifested the greatest eagerness to be upon deck, to watch for the sledge which had before appeared; but I have persuaded him to remain in the cabin, for he is far too weak to sustain the rawness of the atmosphere.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
eventual (adjective)	expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating	*He entered attentively into all my arguments in favour of my eventual success, and into every minute detail of the measures I had taken to secure it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
irradiated (verb)	lit up	*Even now, as I commence my task, his full-toned voice swells in my ears; his lustrous eyes dwell on me*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		with all their melancholy sweetness; I see his thin hand raised in animation, while the lineaments of his face are irradiated by the soul within.	
benevolently (adverb)	in a kind, well-meaning way	*"And yet you rescued me from a strange and perilous situation; you have benevolently restored me to life."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conciliating (adjective)	friendly and trying to win good will	*Yet his manners are so conciliating and gentle, that the sailors are all interested in him, although they have had very little communication with him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oppresses (verb)	come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority	*But he is generally melancholy and despairing; and sometimes he gnashes his teeth, as if impatient of the weight of woes that oppresses him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trickle (verb)	to flow in drops	*At first I perceived that he tried to suppress his emotion; he placed his hands before his eyes; and my voice quivered and failed me, as I beheld tears trickle fast from between his fingers—a groan burst from his heaving breast.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know

Chapter quiz

1. What does the crew first see on the ice?

   A. A polar bear

   B. A lost ship

C. A gigantic figure on a dog sled

D. A fire

2. Who is rescued from the ice?

A. A Russian sailor

B. Victor Frankenstein

C. The creature

D. Henry Clerval

3. Why does Victor decide to tell his story?

A. To earn passage home

B. Because he is dying of fever

C. To confess a theft

D. To warn Walton about dangerous ambition

4. How does Walton feel toward the stranger?

A. He admires and loves him like a brother

B. He fears him

C. He distrusts him

D. He ignores him

5. What narrative structure begins here?

A. A single third-person narrator

B. A frame narrative with a story within a story

C. A play

D. A diary only

6. In the line "Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.", what does "capitulated" most nearly mean?

A. taught; educated

B. instruments that make distant objects look closer

C. gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)

D. cold, damp harshness

7. In the line "You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.", what does "tutored" most nearly mean?

A. cold, damp harshness

B. taught; educated

C. instruments that make distant objects look closer

D. gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)

Answer key: 1. C (A gigantic figure on a dog sled); 2. B (Victor Frankenstein); 3. D (To warn Walton about dangerous ambition); 4. A (He admires and loves him like a brother); 5. B (A frame narrative with a story within a story); 6. C (gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)); 7. B (taught; educated)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter IV,” how does Shelley show the meeting of two ambitious men? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Letter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Letter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Letter IV suggests about the meeting of two ambitious men. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Letter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the meeting of two ambitious men follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter IV and its treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter IV as evidence for a larger claim about the meeting of two ambitious men in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “telescopes” most nearly mean?

   A. come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority

   B. instruments that make distant objects look closer

   C. to flow in drops

   D. friendly and trying to win good will

2. *About two o’clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end. Some of my comrades groaned, and my own mind began to grow watchful with anxious thoughts, when a strange sight suddenly attracted our attention, and diverted our solicitude from our own situation. We perceived a low carriage, fixed on a sledge and drawn by dogs, pass on towards the north, at the distance of half a mile: a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature, sat in the sledge, and guided the dogs. We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter IV”?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. Destroying the companion

   D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. B (instruments that make distant objects look closer); 2. D (The meeting of two ambitious men)

Lesson 7: Chapter I

Focus: a privileged childhood and family love

Content note (gender and ownership): Elizabeth is given to Victor as a "pretty present"; name the language of possession and discuss how the novel treats women as objects of exchange.
Student preview: This chapter describes a girl being 'given' to a boy as a present. We will look critically at that language.
Suggested language: "What does it tell us that Elizabeth is described as a gift? Whose point of view is that?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His childhood is loving and protected.

Background: Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature.

Significance: Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This chapter describes a girl being 'given' to a boy as a present. We will look critically at that language.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are foldings, vagrants, decreasing, chamois, dungeons. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape." In this sentence it means: folds or hollows (here, in the hills). Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to a privileged childhood and family love? I circle "decreasing", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support. But Caroline Beaufort possessed a mind of an uncommon mould; and her courage rose to support her in her adversity. She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Setting, Foreshadowing: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about a privileged childhood and family love, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a privileged childhood and family love. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
foldings (noun)	folds or hollows (here, in the hills)	*During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vagrants (noun)	homeless wanderers	*The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decreasing (verb)	becoming smaller or less	*His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chamois (noun)	a small, agile mountain goat	*When my father returned from Milan, he found playing with me in the hall of our villa, a child fairer than pictured cherub—a creature who seemed to shed radiance from her looks, and whose form and motions were lighter than the chamois of the hills.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dungeons (noun)	dark underground prison cells	*Whether he had died, or still lingered in the dungeons of Austria, was not known.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rambles (noun)	an aimless amble on a winding course	*I, their eldest child, was born at Naples, and as an infant accompanied them in their rambles.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
		He came like a protecting spirit to the poor girl, who committed herself to his	“interment”: From Old French enterrement "burial," from enterrer "to

interment (noun)	the ritual placing of a corpse in a grave	*care; and after the interment of his friend, he conducted her to Geneva, and placed her under the protection of a relation.*	put in the earth" (Latin terra "earth"). (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/interment)
pittance (noun)	an inadequate payment	*She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
confiscated (verb)	take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority	*His property was confiscated, his child became an orphan and a beggar.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
deplored (verb)	express strong disapproval of	*He bitterly deplored the false pride which led his friend to a conduct so little worthy of the affection that united them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where is Victor's family from?
   A. Paris
   B. Naples
   C. London
   D. Geneva
2. How does Elizabeth join the family?
   A. An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother
   B. She is a cousin from England
   C. She is a servant
   D. She is Victor's sister by birth
3. How does Victor's mother describe Elizabeth to him?
   A. As a pretty present for him

B. As a burden

C. As his teacher

D. As a dangerous stranger

4. What kind of childhood does Victor have?

A. Spent at sea

B. Cruel and poor

C. Lonely and neglected

D. Loving and sheltered

5. Why is this childhood important to the novel?

A. It contrasts with the creature's abandonment

B. It shows Victor's poverty

C. It explains Walton's voyage

D. It introduces the North Pole

6. In the line “During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.”, what does “foldings” most nearly mean?

A. becoming smaller or less

B. homeless wanderers

C. folds or hollows (here, in the hills)

D. a small, agile mountain goat

7. In the line “The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.”, what does “vagrants” most nearly mean?

A. folds or hollows (here, in the hills)

B. homeless wanderers

C. becoming smaller or less

D. a small, agile mountain goat

Answer key: 1. D (Geneva); 2. A (An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother); 3. A (As a pretty present for him); 4. D (Loving and sheltered); 5. A (It contrasts with the creature's abandonment); 6. C (folds or hollows (here, in the hills)); 7. B (homeless wanderers)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter I,” how does Shelley show a privileged childhood and family love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of a privileged childhood and family love? State a clear claim,

support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter I suggests about a privileged childhood and family love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter I to complicate the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a privileged childhood and family love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a privileged childhood and family love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter I and its treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter I as evidence for a larger claim about a privileged childhood and family love in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “decreasing” most nearly mean?

   A. becoming smaller or less

   B. take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority

   C. an inadequate payment

   D. express strong disapproval of

2. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support. But Caroline Beaufort possessed a mind of an uncommon mould; and her courage rose to support her in her adversity. She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter I”?

   A. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

   B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   C. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   D. A privileged childhood and family love

SAT key: 1. A (becoming smaller or less); 2. D (A privileged childhood and family love)

Lesson 8: Chapter II

Focus: the first spark of obsession

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.

Background: Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin.

Significance: Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are ligaments, disunion, loudness, preceptors, dissect. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin." In this sentence it means: ties or bonds that hold things together. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin. Why does this chapter matter? Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices —a key point for discussion. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the first spark of obsession? I circle "dissect", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses. The most learned philosopher knew little more. He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery. He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him. I had gazed upon the fortifications and impediments that seemed to keep human beings from entering the citadel of nature, and rashly and ignorantly I had repined.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Symbolism: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the first spark of obsession, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the first spark of obsession. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
ligaments (noun)	ties or bonds that hold things together	*Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disunion (noun)	disagreement; being divided	*I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
loudness (noun)	the quality of being loud	*It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
preceptors (noun)	teachers	*Under the guidance of my new preceptors, I entered with the greatest diligence into the search of the philosopher's stone and the elixir of life; but the latter soon obtained my undivided attention.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dissect (verb)	to cut apart in order to examine closely	*He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
relinquishing (verb)	part with a possession or right	*Her victory was announced by an unusual tranquillity and gladness of soul, which followed the relinquishing of my ancient and latterly tormenting studies.*	"relinquishing": From Latin relinquere "to leave behind," from re- "back" + linquere "to leave." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/relinquish)
unveiled (verb)	remove the veil from	*He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
			Student look-up (not yet verified)

invulnerable (adjective)	immune to attack; impregnable	*Wealth was an inferior object; but what glory would attend the discovery, if I could banish disease from the human frame, and render man invulnerable to any but a violent death!*	
splintered (verb)	broken into sharp pieces	*It was not splintered by the shock, but entirely reduced to thin ribbons of wood.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predilection (noun)	a predisposition in favor of something	*Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate; I desire, therefore, in this narration, to state those facts which led to my predilection for that science.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Which author first fascinates Victor?
   A. Cornelius Agrippa
   B. Homer
   C. Isaac Newton
   D. Shakespeare
2. What does Victor's father call Agrippa's work?
   A. Brilliant science
   B. A great adventure
   C. Holy truth
   D. Sad trash
3. What event introduces Victor to electricity?
   A. A fire in the house
   B. A storm at sea

C. A shock from a machine

D. Lightning destroying an oak tree

4. Who is Victor's closest childhood friend?

A. Henry Clerval

B. Robert Walton

C. Felix De Lacey

D. M. Krempe

5. What does Victor say governed his life?

A. Religion

B. Destiny

C. Money

D. His mother

6. In the line “Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.”, what does “ligaments” most nearly mean?

A. disagreement; being divided

B. teachers

C. the quality of being loud

D. ties or bonds that hold things together

7. In the line “I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.”, what does “disunion” most nearly mean?

A. the quality of being loud

B. teachers

C. disagreement; being divided

D. ties or bonds that hold things together

Answer key: 1. A (Cornelius Agrippa); 2. D (Sad trash); 3. D (Lightning destroying an oak tree); 4. A (Henry Clerval); 5. B (Destiny); 6. D (ties or bonds that hold things together); 7. C (disagreement; being divided)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter II,” how does Shelley show the first spark of obsession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first spark of obsession? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with

at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter II suggests about the first spark of obsession. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first spark of obsession responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first spark of obsession follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter II and its treatment of the first spark of obsession. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter II as evidence for a larger claim about the first spark of obsession in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first spark of obsession. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "loudness" most nearly mean?

   A. immune to attack; impregnable
   B. the quality of being loud
   C. broken into sharp pieces
   D. a predisposition in favor of something

2. *The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses. The most learned philosopher knew little more. He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery. He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him. I had gazed upon the fortifications and impediments that seemed to keep human beings from entering the citadel of nature, and rashly and ignorantly I had repined.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter II"?

   A. First experiences of the senses
   B. Delay and dread
   C. Isolation in the north
   D. The first spark of obsession

SAT key: 1. B (the quality of being loud); 2. D (The first spark of obsession)

Lesson 9: Chapter III

Focus: loss and leaving home

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.

Background: Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era.

Significance: Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are prepossess, crucible, residents, fatiguing, chimeras. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits." In this sentence it means: to make someone feel favorably in advance. Word histories: "prepossess": pre- "before" + possess: first "to occupy beforehand," later "to fill someone beforehand with a (favorable) feeling." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era. Why does this chapter matter? Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to loss and leaving home? I circle "fatiguing", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing. At length the high white steeple of the town met my eyes. I alighted, and was conducted to my solitary apartment, to spend the evening as I pleased.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about loss and leaving home, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes loss and leaving home. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
prepossess (verb)	to make someone feel favorably in advance	*Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.*	"prepossess": pre- "before" + possess: first "to occupy beforehand," later "to fill someone beforehand with a (favorable) feeling." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/prepossess)
crucible (noun)	a heat-resistant container used for melting substances	*But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
residents (noun)	people who live in a place	*Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fatiguing (adjective)	tiring	*I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chimeras (noun)	wild, impossible dreams or fantasies	*I was required to exchange chimeras of boundless grandeur for realities of little worth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
transmuted (verb)	changed into a different substance	*The modern masters promise very little; they know that metals cannot be transmuted, and that the elixir of life is a chimera.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
panegyric (noun)	a speech or piece of writing full of praise	*After having made a few preparatory experiments, he concluded with a panegyric upon modern chemistry, the terms of which I shall never forget:—*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
insurrection (noun)	organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction	*My internal being was in a state of insurrection and turmoil; I felt that order would thence*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

	tries to wrest control from another	*arise, but I had no power to produce it.*	
commences (verb)	take the first step or steps in carrying out an action	*These are the reflections of the first days; but when the lapse of time proves the reality of the evil, then the actual bitterness of grief commences.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
imbibed (verb)	take in, also metaphorically	*Good God! in what desert land have you lived, where no one was kind enough to inform you that these fancies, which you have so greedily imbibed, are a thousand years old, and as musty as they are ancient?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. How does Victor's mother die?
   A. A carriage accident
   B. Drowning
   C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth
   D. Old age
2. What is her dying wish?
   A. That Victor become a priest
   B. That the family move
   C. That Victor stay home
   D. That Victor and Elizabeth marry
3. Where does Victor go to university?
   A. Ingolstadt
   B. Geneva
   C. Paris

D. Oxford

4. Which professor inspires Victor?
   A. M. Krempe
   B. Dr. Darwin
   C. M. Waldman
   D. M. Clerval
5. How does M. Krempe react to Victor's reading?
   A. He scorns it as outdated nonsense
   B. He gives Victor more alchemy books
   C. He praises it
   D. He expels Victor
6. In the line "Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.", what does "prepossess" most nearly mean?
   A. tiring
   B. to make someone feel favorably in advance
   C. a heat-resistant container used for melting substances
   D. people who live in a place
7. In the line "But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.", what does "crucible" most nearly mean?
   A. tiring
   B. to make someone feel favorably in advance
   C. a heat-resistant container used for melting substances
   D. people who live in a place

Answer key: 1. C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth); 2. D (That Victor and Elizabeth marry); 3. A (Ingolstadt); 4. C (M. Waldman); 5. A (He scorns it as outdated nonsense); 6. B (to make someone feel favorably in advance); 7. C (a heat-resistant container used for melting substances)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter III," how does Shelley show loss and leaving home? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of loss and leaving home? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at

least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter III suggests about loss and leaving home. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter III to complicate the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loss and leaving home responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loss and leaving home follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter III and its treatment of loss and leaving home. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter III as evidence for a larger claim about loss and leaving home in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loss and leaving home. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*

As used in the text, what does the word "residents" most nearly mean?

A. organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction tries to wrest control from another

B. people who live in a place

C. take in, also metaphorically

D. take the first step or steps in carrying out an action

2. *I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing. At length the high white steeple of the town met my eyes. I alighted, and was conducted to my solitary apartment, to spend the evening as I pleased.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter III"?

A. The first death and growing guilt

B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

C. Loss and leaving home

D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. B (people who live in a place); 2. C (Loss and leaving home)

Lesson 10: Chapter IV

Focus: obsession and the discovery of life

Content note (grave-robbing, dissection): Victor describes collecting body parts from charnel-houses and dissecting rooms. Keep the focus on ambition and ethics, not gore.
Student preview: This chapter describes Victor gathering materials from graves and dissecting rooms.
Suggested language: "What lines does Victor cross here, and does he notice them?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.

Background: Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science.

Significance: Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This chapter describes Victor gathering materials from graves and dissecting rooms.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are procrastinate, slaughterhouse, dissecting, dabbled, charnel. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed." In this sentence it means: to put off doing something. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science. Why does this chapter matter? Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, an" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to obsession and the discovery of life? I circle "unguarded", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, and you will easily perceive why I am reserved upon that subject. I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery. Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge, and how much happier that man is who believes his native town to be the world, than he who aspires to become greater than his nature will allow.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Tone / mood, Imagery: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about obsession and the discovery of life, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes obsession and the discovery of life. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
procrastinate (verb)	to put off doing something	*I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
slaughterhouse (noun)	a building where animals are killed for meat	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dissecting (adjective)	used for cutting up bodies to study them	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dabbled (verb)	dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid	*Who shall conceive the horrors of my secret toil, as I dabbled among the unhallowed damps of the grave, or tortured the living animal to animate the lifeless clay?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
charnel (noun)	a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited	*Now I was led to examine the cause and progress of this decay, and forced to spend days and nights in vaults and charnel-houses.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disquieted (verb)	disturb in mind or make uneasy or cause to be worried or alarmed	*I knew my silence disquieted them; and I well remembered the words of my father: "I know that while you are pleased with yourself, you will think of us with affection, and we shall hear regularly from you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
abstruse (adjective)	difficult to penetrate; incomprehensible to one of ordinary understanding or knowledge	*In a thousand ways he smoothed for me the path of knowledge, and made the most abstruse enquiries clear and facile to my apprehension.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

unguarded (adjective)	frank; careless about hiding feelings	*I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vintage (noun)	a season's yield of wine from a vineyard	*It was a most beautiful season; never did the fields bestow a more plentiful harvest, or the vines yield a more luxuriant vintage: but my eyes were insensible to the charms of nature.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
physiology (noun)	the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms	*I revolved these circumstances in my mind, and determined thenceforth to apply myself more particularly to those branches of natural philosophy which relate to physiology.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What does Victor discover?
   A. A route to the pole
   B. A cure for fever
   C. A new planet
   D. The cause of generation and life
2. Where does Victor gather materials?
   A. A church garden
   B. The forest
   C. The market
   D. Charnel houses and dissecting rooms
3. Why does Victor make the being gigantic?
   A. By accident
   B. The small parts were hard to work with
   C. To frighten enemies
   D. To make it strong for labor

4. What happens to Victor's health and relationships?
   A. He becomes stronger
   B. He travels widely
   C. He neglects his family and grows ill and pale
   D. He marries
5. What does Victor refuse to share with Walton?
   A. His age
   B. His family's names
   C. The secret of how he created life
   D. The location of Geneva
6. In the line "I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.", what does "procrastinate" most nearly mean?
   A. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid
   B. used for cutting up bodies to study them
   C. a building where animals are killed for meat
   D. to put off doing something
7. In the line "The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.", what does "slaughterhouse" most nearly mean?
   A. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid
   B. a building where animals are killed for meat
   C. to put off doing something
   D. used for cutting up bodies to study them

Answer key: 1. D (The cause of generation and life); 2. D (Charnel houses and dissecting rooms); 3. B (The small parts were hard to work with); 4. C (He neglects his family and grows ill and pale); 5. C (The secret of how he created life); 6. D (to put off doing something); 7. B (a building where animals are killed for meat)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter IV," how does Shelley show obsession and the discovery of life? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of obsession and the discovery of life? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IV suggests about obsession and the discovery of life. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of obsession and the discovery of life responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of obsession and the discovery of life follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IV and its treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IV as evidence for a larger claim about obsession and the discovery of life in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist,

psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "dissecting" most nearly mean?

   A. a season's yield of wine from a vineyard
   B. frank; careless about hiding feelings
   C. the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms
   D. used for cutting up bodies to study them

2. *I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, and you will easily perceive why I am reserved upon that subject. I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery. Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge, and how much happier that man is who believes his native town to be the world, than he who aspires to become greater than his nature will allow.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IV"?

   A. Learning compassion by watching
   B. Reading and identity
   C. Obsession and the discovery of life
   D. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

SAT key: 1. D (used for cutting up bodies to study them); 2. C (Obsession and the discovery of life)

Lesson 11: Chapter V

Focus: horror at the moment of creation

Teacher only · spoilers

On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed by Henry.

Background: Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt.

Significance: The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are agitates, palpitated, infusing, relapses, lassitude. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: ""Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting." In this sentence it means: upsets; disturbs. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt. Why does this chapter matter? The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for imagery.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to horror at the moment of creation? I circle "palpitated", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find imagery, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for imagery.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of imagery. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind. I traversed the streets, without any clear conception of where I was, or what I was doing. My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Imagery, Tone / mood, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about horror at the moment of creation, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes horror at the moment of creation. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
agitates (verb)	upsets; disturbs	*"Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
palpitated (verb)	beat fast and hard (of the heart)	*My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
infusing (verb)	putting a quality or feeling into something	*I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
relapses (noun)	returns of an illness after improvement	*By very slow degrees, and with frequent relapses, that alarmed and grieved my friend, I recovered.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
lassitude (noun)	tiredness and lack of energy	*At length lassitude succeeded to the tumult I had before endured; and I threw myself on the bed in my clothes, endeavouring to seek a few moments of forgetfulness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
convalescence (noun)	gradual healing (through rest) after sickness or injury	*It was a divine spring; and the season contributed greatly to my convalescence.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
alighting (verb)	to come to rest, settle	*"My dear Frankenstein," exclaimed he, "how glad I am to see you! how fortunate that you should be here at the very moment of my alighting!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unbounded (adjective)	seemingly boundless in amount, number, degree, or especially extent	*But I was in reality very ill; and surely nothing but the unbounded and unremitting attentions of my friend could have restored me to life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wildness (noun)	a feeling of extreme emotional intensity	*Clerval at first attributed my unusual spirits to joy on his arrival; but when he observed me more attentively, he saw a wildness in my eyes for which he could not account; and my loud, unrestrained, heartless laughter, frightened and astonished him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bedchamber (noun)	a room used primarily for sleeping	*Unable to endure the aspect of the being I had created, I rushed out of the room, and continued a long time traversing my bedchamber, unable to compose my mind to sleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.

2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What month does the creature come to life?
   A. March
   B. December
   C. November
   D. June
2. What first feature of the creature does Victor describe?
   A. Its dull yellow eye
   B. Its smile
   C. Its voice
   D. Its hands
3. What does Victor dream after fleeing?
   A. He sails north
   B. Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse
   C. He is drowning
   D. He is crowned king
4. Who arrives in Ingolstadt and nurses Victor?
   A. Walton
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Henry Clerval
   D. Alphonse
5. What is ironic about this chapter?
   A. The creature is tiny
   B. Clerval is a scientist
   C. Victor is happy
   D. Victor abandons the being he worked years to create
6. In the line ""Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.", what does "agitates" most nearly mean?
   A. beat fast and hard (of the heart)

B. upsets; disturbs

C. returns of an illness after improvement

D. putting a quality or feeling into something

7. In the line “My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—”, what does “palpitated” most nearly mean?

A. returns of an illness after improvement

B. putting a quality or feeling into something

C. beat fast and hard (of the heart)

D. upsets; disturbs

Answer key: 1. C (November); 2. A (Its dull yellow eye); 3. B (Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse); 4. C (Henry Clerval); 5. D (Victor abandons the being he worked years to create); 6. B (upsets; disturbs); 7. C (beat fast and hard (of the heart))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter V,” how does Shelley show horror at the moment of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter V, how does Shelley develop the idea of horror at the moment of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter V suggests about horror at the moment of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary

argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses imagery in Chapter V to complicate the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter V within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of horror at the moment of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of horror at the moment of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter V and its treatment of horror at the moment of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter V as evidence for a larger claim about horror at the moment of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter V as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of horror at the moment of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “infusing” most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of extreme emotional intensity

   B. seemingly boundless in amount, number, degree, or especially extent

   C. a room used primarily for sleeping

   D. putting a quality or feeling into something

2. *I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind. I traversed the streets, without any clear conception of where I was, or what I was doing. My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter V”?

   A. Horror at the moment of creation

   B. Destroying the companion

C. Despair and the sublime

D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. D (putting a quality or feeling into something); 2. A (Horror at the moment of creation)

Lesson 12: Chapter VI

Focus: recovery and false peace

Teacher only · spoilers

Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.

Background: Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry.

Significance: The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are salubrious, congratulatory, encomiums, vacillating, devolved. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend." In this sentence it means: healthy; good for the body. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry. Why does this chapter matter? The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to recovery and false peace? I circle "dimples", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find setting, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for setting.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William. I wish you could see him; he is very tall of his age, with sweet laughing blue eyes, dark eyelashes, and curling hair. When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health. He has already had one or two little wives, but Louisa Biron is his favourite, a pretty little girl of five years of age.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Tone / mood, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about recovery and false peace, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes recovery and false peace. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
salubrious (adjective)	healthy; good for the body	*We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

congratulatory (adjective)	expressing congratulations	*The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
encomiums (noun)	speeches or remarks of high praise	*Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vacillating (verb)	be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action	*The poor woman was very vacillating in her repentance.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
devolved (verb)	fallen as a duty (on someone)	*I figure to myself that the task of attending on your sick bed has devolved on some mercenary old nurse, who could never guess your wishes, nor minister to them with the care and affection of your poor cousin.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dialects (noun)	the usage or vocabulary that is characteristic of a specific group of people	*I did not, like him, attempt a critical knowledge of their dialects, for I did not contemplate making any other use of them than temporary amusement.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
alleging (verb)	giving as a reason	*Clerval, whose eyes and feelings were always quick in discerning the sensations of others, declined the subject, alleging, in excuse, his total ignorance; and the conversation took a more general turn.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dimples (noun)	small hollows in the cheeks, seen when smiling	*When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retarded (verb)	cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate	*Summer passed away in these occupations, and my return to Geneva was fixed for the latter end of autumn; but being delayed by several accidents, winter and snow arrived, the roads were deemed impassable, and my journey was retarded until the ensuing spring.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
diffident (adjective)	showing modest reserve	*Young men should be diffident of themselves, you know, M.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who writes to Victor during his recovery?
   A. Walton
   B. His mother
   C. Krempe
   D. Elizabeth
2. Who is Justine Moritz?
   A. An innkeeper
   B. A girl who became a servant and part of the family
   C. A professor
   D. Victor's sister
3. How does Victor now feel about natural philosophy?
   A. He loves it more
   B. He teaches it
   C. He is indifferent
   D. He cannot bear it
4. What does Clerval study?
   A. Medicine
   B. Chemistry
   C. Oriental languages
   D. Astronomy
5. What restores Victor's spirits?
   A. A sea voyage
   B. A party
   C. A walking tour in nature with Clerval
   D. A new experiment
6. In the line “We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.”, what does “salubrious” most nearly mean?
   A. speeches or remarks of high praise
   B. be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action
   C. expressing congratulations
   D. healthy; good for the body

7. In the line “The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.”, what does “congratulatory” most nearly mean?
   A. healthy; good for the body
   B. be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action
   C. speeches or remarks of high praise
   D. expressing congratulations

Answer key: 1. D (Elizabeth); 2. B (A girl who became a servant and part of the family); 3. D (He cannot bear it); 4. C (Oriental languages); 5. C (A walking tour in nature with Clerval); 6. D (healthy; good for the body); 7. D (expressing congratulations)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VI,” how does Shelley show recovery and false peace? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VI, how does Shelley develop the idea of recovery and false peace? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VI suggests about recovery and false peace. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter VI to complicate the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of recovery and false peace responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of recovery and false peace follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VI and its treatment of recovery and false peace. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VI as evidence for a larger claim about recovery and false peace in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of recovery and false peace. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “encomiums” most nearly mean?

   A. speeches or remarks of high praise

   B. cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate

   C. showing modest reserve

   D. small hollows in the cheeks, seen when smiling

2. *“I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William. I wish you could see him; he is very tall of his age, with sweet laughing blue eyes, dark eyelashes, and curling hair. When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health. He has already had one or two little wives, but Louisa Biron is his favourite, a pretty little girl of five years of age.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VI”?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   B. Language, knowledge and sorrow

   C. The demand for a companion

   D. Recovery and false peace

SAT key: 1. A (speeches or remarks of high praise); 2. D (Recovery and false peace)

Lesson 13: Chapter VII

Focus: the first death and growing guilt

Content note (murder of a child): William, a young child, is found murdered. Some students may have experienced loss; allow a pass on reading aloud.
Student preview: This chapter reports the murder of a young child.
Suggested language: "How does the family's grief shape what happens next?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.

Background: The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear.

Significance: Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This chapter reports the murder of a young child.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are cabriolet, prognosticate, scaling, desolating, festering. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend." In this sentence it means: a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the first death and growing guilt? I circle "festering", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds. Enter the house of mourning, my friend, but with kindness and affection for those who love you, and not with hatred for your enemies.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Imagery, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the first death and growing guilt, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the first death and growing guilt. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
cabriolet (noun)	a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse	*But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
prognosticate (verb)	to predict; to be a sign of	*Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scaling (verb)	climbing	*Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
desolating (adjective)	causing great grief or ruin	*One sudden and desolating change had taken place; but a thousand little circumstances might have by degrees worked other alterations, which, although they were done more tranquilly, might not be the less decisive.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
festering (adjective)	infected and full of pus	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
indelible (adjective)	cannot be removed or erased	*Six years had elapsed, passed as a dream but for one indelible trace, and I stood in the same place where I had last embraced my father before my departure for Ingolstadt.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
carnage (noun)	the savage and excessive killing of many people	*I had turned loose into the world a depraved wretch, whose delight was in carnage and misery; had he not murdered my brother?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ravings (noun)	declaiming wildly	*I well knew that if any other had communicated such a relation to me, I should have looked upon it as the ravings of insanity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
credited (verb)	believed	*Besides, the strange nature of the animal would elude all pursuit, even if I were so far credited as to persuade my relatives to commence it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assassin (noun)	a murderer	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who has been murdered?
   A. Alphonse
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Clerval
   D. William, Victor's youngest brother
2. What weather greets Victor near Geneva?
   A. A violent thunderstorm
   B. A heatwave
   C. Fog
   D. A blizzard
3. What does the lightning reveal?
   A. Justine
   B. The creature on the mountainside
   C. A burning house
   D. A ship
4. Who is accused of the murder?
   A. Ernest
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Justine Moritz
   D. Clerval
5. What evidence was found on the accused?
   A. The miniature portrait (locket) William wore
   B. Blood
   C. A knife
   D. A letter
6. In the line “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.”, what does “cabriolet” most nearly mean?
   A. to predict; to be a sign of
   B. climbing
   C. a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse
   D. causing great grief or ruin

7. In the line “Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?””, what does “prognosticate” most nearly mean?
   A. to predict; to be a sign of
   B. causing great grief or ruin
   C. climbing
   D. a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse

Answer key: 1. D (William, Victor's youngest brother); 2. A (A violent thunderstorm); 3. B (The creature on the mountainside); 4. C (Justine Moritz); 5. A (The miniature portrait (locket) William wore); 6. C (a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse); 7. A (to predict; to be a sign of)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VII,” how does Shelley show the first death and growing guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first death and growing guilt? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VII suggests about the first death and growing guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first death and growing guilt responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first death and growing guilt follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VII and its treatment of the first death and growing guilt. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VII as evidence for a larger claim about the first death and growing guilt in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first death and growing guilt. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “scaling” most nearly mean?

   A. a murderer

   B. climbing

   C. declaiming wildly

   D. believed

2. *“Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds. Enter the house of mourning, my friend, but with kindness and affection for those who love you, and not with hatred for your enemies.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VII”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. The final reckoning

   C. Obsession and the discovery of life

   D. The first death and growing guilt

SAT key: 1. B (climbing); 2. D (The first death and growing guilt)

Lesson 14: Chapter VIII

Focus: injustice and the burden of silence

Content note (wrongful execution, coerced confession): Justine is pressured into a false confession and executed. Frame it as injustice and discuss how institutions fail the vulnerable.
Student preview: An innocent character is pressured to confess and is executed.
Suggested language: "Why does Justine confess to something she did not do? Who is responsible?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.

Background: Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure.

Significance: Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: An innocent character is pressured to confess and is executed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are tarnish, consoles, unmingled, playfellow, gnashed. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness." In this sentence it means: to dull or stain the brightness of. Word histories: "consoles": From Latin consolari "to comfort," from com- (intensive) + solari "to comfort." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure. Why does this chapter matter? Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to injustice and the burden of silence? I circle "unmingled", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find irony, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness. In the morning I went to the court; my lips and throat were parched. I dared not ask the fatal question; but I was known, and the officer guessed the cause of my visit. The ballots had been thrown; they were all black, and Justine was condemned.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about injustice and the burden of silence, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes injustice and the burden of silence. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
tarnish (verb)	to dull or stain the brightness of	*Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
consoles (verb)	comforts in a time of sadness	*I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."*	"consoles": From Latin consolari "to comfort," from com- (intensive) + solari "to comfort." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/console)
unmingled (adjective)	pure; not mixed with anything else	*I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
playfellow (noun)	a companion at play	*You shall not die!—You, my playfellow, my companion, my sister, perish on the scaffold!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
gnashed (verb)	grind together, of teeth	*I gnashed my teeth, and ground them together, uttering a groan that came from my inmost soul.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
heartrending (adjective)	causing or marked by grief or anguish	*Elizabeth's heartrending eloquence failed to move the judges from their settled conviction in the criminality of the saintly sufferer.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
removes (noun)	degree of figurative distance or separation; or	*It removes more than half my misfortune; and I feel as if I could die in peace, now that my innocence is acknowledged by you, dear lady, and your cousin."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
distrusted (verb)	regard as untrustworthy; regard with suspicion; have no faith or confidence in	*"Oh, Justine! forgive me for having for one moment distrusted you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
excommunication (noun)	the state of being excommunicated	*He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
subscribed (verb)	offer to buy, as of stocks and shares		Student look-up (not yet verified)

		In an evil hour I subscribed to a lie; and now only am I truly miserable."	

Discussion questions

1. Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What happens at Justine's trial?
   A. She is freed
   B. She escapes
   C. She is convicted and condemned
   D. The trial is cancelled
2. Why does Justine confess falsely?
   A. She wanted to protect Victor
   B. She was bribed
   C. She forgot
   D. Her confessor threatened her with damnation
3. Who speaks publicly for Justine?
   A. Victor
   B. Alphonse
   C. Clerval
   D. Elizabeth
4. How does Victor respond?
   A. He accuses Ernest
   B. He leaves Geneva
   C. He confesses
   D. He suffers in silence
5. What theme does the trial highlight?
   A. The love of travel
   B. The power of science
   C. The joy of law

D. The failure of justice

6. In the line “Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.”, what does “tarnish” most nearly mean?
   A. pure; not mixed with anything else
   B. comforts in a time of sadness
   C. a companion at play
   D. to dull or stain the brightness of
7. In the line “I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death.””, what does “consoles” most nearly mean?
   A. to dull or stain the brightness of
   B. pure; not mixed with anything else
   C. comforts in a time of sadness
   D. a companion at play

Answer key: 1. C (She is convicted and condemned); 2. D (Her confessor threatened her with damnation); 3. D (Elizabeth); 4. D (He suffers in silence); 5. D (The failure of justice); 6. D (to dull or stain the brightness of); 7. C (comforts in a time of sadness)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VIII,” how does Shelley show injustice and the burden of silence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and the burden of silence? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VIII suggests

about injustice and the burden of silence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and the burden of silence responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and the burden of silence follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VIII and its treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VIII as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and the burden of silence in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “unmingled” most nearly mean?

   A. offer to buy, as of stocks and shares

   B. the state of being excommunicated

   C. pure; not mixed with anything else

   D. regard as untrustworthy; regard with suspicion; have no faith or confidence in

2. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness. In the morning I went to the court; my lips and throat were parched. I dared not ask the fatal question; but I was known, and the officer guessed the cause of my visit. The ballots had been thrown; they were all black, and Justine was condemned.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VIII"?

A. Horror at the moment of creation
B. Reading and identity
C. Isolation in the north
D. Injustice and the burden of silence

SAT key: 1. C (pure; not mixed with anything else); 2. D (Injustice and the burden of silence)

Lesson 15: Chapter IX

Focus: despair and the sublime

Content note (suicidal thoughts): Victor contemplates ending his life. Use the safe-messaging script; the quiz item is worded as what his despair leads him to contemplate.
Student preview: Victor feels deep despair in this chapter and thinks about ending his life. If this topic is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor.
Suggested language: "What pulls Victor back? How does the landscape affect his despair?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.

Background: The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816).

Significance: The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Victor feels deep despair in this chapter and thinks about ending his life. If this topic is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are overhangs, lulling, glaciers, perpetrate, avalanche. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it." In this sentence it means: sticks out over; hangs over. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816). Why does this chapter matter? The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Our house was the house of mourning." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to despair and the sublime? I circle "desponding", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find setting, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for setting.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Our house was the house of mourning. My father's health was deeply shaken by the horror of the recent events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer that happy creature, who in earlier youth wandered with me on the banks of the lake, and talked with ecstasy of our future prospects. The first of those sorrows which are sent to wean us from the earth, had visited her, and its dimming influence quenched her dearest smiles.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Imagery, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about despair and the sublime, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes despair and the sublime. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overhangs (verb)	sticks out over; hangs over	*I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
lulling (adjective)	calming; making sleepy	*The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
glaciers (noun)	huge slow-moving masses of ice	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
perpetrate (verb)	perform an act, usually with a negative connotation	*I had been the author of unalterable evils; and I lived in daily fear, lest the monster whom I had created should perpetrate some new wickedness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
avalanche (noun)	a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ephemeral (noun)	anything short-lived, as an insect that lives only for a day in its winged form	*It was during an access of this kind that I suddenly left my home, and bending my steps towards the near Alpine valleys, sought in the magnificence, the eternity of such scenes, to forget myself and my ephemeral, because human, sorrows.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
revisit (verb)	visit again	*At these moments I wept bitterly, and wished that peace would revisit my mind only that I might afford them consolation and happiness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

thirsted (verb)	longed for something strongly	*I had begun life with benevolent intentions, and thirsted for the moment when I should put them in practice, and make myself useful to my fellow-beings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assassinated (verb)	murder; especially of socially prominent persons	*William and Justine were assassinated, and the murderer escapes; he walks about the world free, and perhaps respected.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
desponding (adjective)	losing hope; discouraged	*Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed.*	"desponding": From Latin despondere "to give up, lose heart," from de- "away" + spondere "to promise." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/despond)

Discussion questions

1. How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate?
   A. Ending his own life
   B. Becoming a monk
   C. Marrying at once
   D. Moving to England
2. Where does Victor travel for relief?
   A. The Alps near Chamounix
   B. The coast of Italy
   C. Ingolstadt
   D. London
3. Which mountain dominates the scenery?
   A. Ben Nevis
   B. Vesuvius

C. Mont Blanc

D. Everest

4. What literary idea describes the overwhelming landscape?

A. Allegory

B. The sublime

C. Pastoral comedy

D. Satire

5. What effect does nature have on Victor?

A. It makes him ill

B. It bores him

C. It soothes him for a time

D. It angers him

6. In the line "I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.", what does "overhangs" most nearly mean?

A. huge slow-moving masses of ice

B. perform an act, usually with a negative connotation

C. sticks out over; hangs over

D. calming; making sleepy

7. In the line "The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.", what does "lulling" most nearly mean?

A. sticks out over; hangs over

B. huge slow-moving masses of ice

C. perform an act, usually with a negative connotation

D. calming; making sleepy

Answer key: 1. A (Ending his own life); 2. A (The Alps near Chamounix); 3. C (Mont Blanc); 4. B (The sublime); 5. C (It soothes him for a time); 6. C (sticks out over; hangs over); 7. D (calming; making sleepy)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter IX," how does Shelley show despair and the sublime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter IX, how does Shelley develop the idea of despair and the sublime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IX suggests about despair and the sublime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter IX to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter IX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and the sublime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter IX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of despair and the sublime follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IX and its treatment of despair and the sublime. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IX as evidence for a larger claim about despair and the sublime in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and the sublime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic,

feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "glaciers" most nearly mean?

   A. losing hope; discouraged
   B. huge slow-moving masses of ice
   C. longed for something strongly
   D. murder; especially of socially prominent persons

2. *Our house was the house of mourning. My father's health was deeply shaken by the horror of the recent events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer that happy creature, who in earlier youth wandered with me on the banks of the lake, and talked with ecstasy of our future prospects. The first of those sorrows which are sent to wean us from the earth, had visited her, and its dimming influence quenched her dearest smiles.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IX"?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love
   B. The demand for a companion
   C. Rejection and the turn to revenge
   D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. B (huge slow-moving masses of ice); 2. D (Despair and the sublime)

Lesson 16: Chapter X

Focus: confrontation between creator and creation

Teacher only · spoilers

On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.

Background: Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast.

Significance: The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are pollutes, commiserate, inspiriting, diabolically, overlooks. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day." In this sentence it means: spoils; makes impure. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast. Why does this chapter matter? The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for allusion.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to confrontation between creator and creation? I circle "pollutes", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find allusion, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for allusion.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of allusion. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep. We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day. We feel, conceive, or reason; laugh or weep, Embrace fond woe, or cast our cares away; It is the same: for, be it joy or sorrow, The path of its departure still is free. Man's yesterday may ne'er be like his morrow; Nought may endure but mutability!*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Allusion, Characterization, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about confrontation between creator and creation, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes confrontation between creator and creation. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pollutes (verb)	spoils; makes impure	*We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

commiserate (verb)	to feel or show pity for	*Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inspiriting (adjective)	encouraging; filling with spirit	*All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
diabolically (adverb)	as a devil; in an evil manner	*Begone, vile insect! or rather, stay, that I may trample you to dust! and, oh! that I could, with the extinction of your miserable existence, restore those victims whom you have so diabolically murdered!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overlooks (noun)	a high place affording a good view	*For some time I sat upon the rock that overlooks the sea of ice.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
implores (verb)	call upon in supplication; entreat	*Will no entreaties cause thee to turn a favourable eye upon thy creature, who implores thy goodness and compassion?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
illuminate (verb)	make lighter or brighter	*The sun is yet high in the heavens; before it descends to hide itself behind yon snowy precipices, and illuminate another world, you will have heard my story, and can decide.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
barricade (verb)	to block off	*I stood beside the sources of the Arveiron, which take their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of the hills, to barricade the valley.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interspersed (verb)	place at intervals in or among	*The surface is very uneven, rising like the waves of a troubled sea, descending low, and interspersed by rifts that sink deep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
surmount (verb)	get on top of; deal with successfully	*The ascent is precipitous, but the path is cut into continual and short windings, which enable you to surmount the perpendicularity of the mountain.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Victor meet the creature?
   A. In Geneva
   B. In a church
   C. On the glacier at Montanvert
   D. On Walton's ship
2. How does the creature speak?
   A. Not at all
   B. In grunts
   C. Only in German
   D. Eloquently and persuasively
3. Which work does the creature allude to?
   A. Robinson Crusoe
   B. The Odyssey
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Hamlet
4. What does the creature ask of Victor?
   A. To listen to his story
   B. To give him money
   C. To leave Europe
   D. To fight him
5. What is ironic about the creature's speech?
   A. He is silent
   B. He agrees with Victor
   C. He is afraid of ice
   D. The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator
6. In the line “We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.”, what does “pollutes” most nearly mean?
   A. to feel or show pity for
   B. encouraging; filling with spirit
   C. as a devil; in an evil manner
   D. spoils; makes impure
7. In the line “Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.”, what does “commiserate” most nearly mean?
   A. encouraging; filling with spirit
   B. as a devil; in an evil manner
   C. spoils; makes impure
   D. to feel or show pity for

Answer key: 1. C (On the glacier at Montanvert); 2. D (Eloquently and persuasively); 3. C (Paradise Lost); 4. A (To listen to his story); 5. D (The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator); 6. D (spoils; makes impure); 7. D (to feel or show pity for)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter X,” how does Shelley show confrontation between creator and creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter X, how does Shelley develop the idea of confrontation between creator and creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter X (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter X suggests about confrontation between creator and creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter X to complicate the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter X within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confrontation between creator and creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter X alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confrontation between creator and creation follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter X and its treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter X as evidence for a larger claim about confrontation between creator and creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter X as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “inspiriting” most nearly mean?

   A. encouraging; filling with spirit

   B. to block off

   C. get on top of; deal with successfully

   D. place at intervals in or among

2. *We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep. We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day. We feel, conceive, or reason; laugh or weep, Embrace fond woe, or cast our cares away; It is the same: for, be it joy or sorrow, The path of its departure still is free. Man’s yesterday may ne’er be like his morrow; Nought may endure but mutability!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter X”?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. Horror at the moment of creation

   C. Confrontation between creator and creation

   D. Obsession and the discovery of life

SAT key: 1. A (encouraging; filling with spirit); 2. C (Confrontation between creator and creation)

Lesson 17: Chapter XI

Focus: first experiences of the senses

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.

Background: Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience.

Significance: The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are debilitated, canopied, incommoded, purloined, blackbird. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable." In this sentence it means: weakened. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience. Why does this chapter matter? The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to first experiences of the senses? I circle "blackbird", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find point of view, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for point of view.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest. My sensations had, by this time, become distinct, and my mind received every day additional ideas. My eyes became accustomed to the light, and to perceive objects in their right forms; I distinguished the insect from the herb, and, by degrees, one herb from another. I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Imagery, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about first experiences of the senses, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes first experiences of the senses. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
debilitated (adjective)	weakened	*He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

canopied (verb)	covered overhead like a canopy	*I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
incommoded (verb)	troubled; inconvenienced	*As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
purloined (verb)	make off with belongings of others	*I had first, however, provided for my sustenance for that day, by a loaf of coarse bread, which I purloined, and a cup with which I could drink, more conveniently than from my hand, of the pure water which flowed by my retreat.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
blackbird (noun)	any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black	*I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wearying (verb)	exhaust or get tired through overuse or great strain or stress	*The light became more and more oppressive to me; and, the heat wearying me as I walked, I sought a place where I could receive shade.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*The silver hair and benevolent countenance of the aged cottager won my reverence, while the gentle manners of the girl enticed my love.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
carpeted (verb)	covered as if with a carpet	*"Having thus arranged my dwelling, and carpeted it with clean straw, I retired; for I saw the figure of a man at a distance, and I remembered too well my treatment the night before, to trust myself in his power.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intercepted (verb)	seize on its way	*I was delighted when I first discovered that a pleasant sound, which often saluted my ears, proceeded from the throats of the little winged animals who had often intercepted the light from my eyes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assuage (verb)	cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of	*"Food, however, became scarce; and I often spent the whole day searching in vain for a few acorns to assuage the pangs of hunger.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who narrates this chapter?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Walton
   C. The creature
   D. Victor
2. What does the creature discover that both warms and burns?
   A. Fire
   B. Iron
   C. Water
   D. Snow
3. How do villagers react to him?
   A. They ignore him
   B. They welcome him
   C. They worship him
   D. They attack him
4. Where does he take shelter?
   A. A cave in the Alps
   B. A hovel attached to a cottage
   C. A castle
   D. A church
5. What pleases him in nature?
   A. Moonlight and birdsong
   B. Machines
   C. Thunder
   D. Crowded towns
6. In the line "He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.", what does "debilitated" most nearly mean?
   A. troubled; inconvenienced
   B. make off with belongings of others
   C. weakened
   D. covered overhead like a canopy
7. In the line "I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.", what does "canopied" most nearly mean?
   A. troubled; inconvenienced

B. weakened

C. covered overhead like a canopy

D. make off with belongings of others

Answer key: 1. C (The creature); 2. A (Fire); 3. D (They attack him); 4. B (A hovel attached to a cottage); 5. A (Moonlight and birdsong); 6. C (weakened); 7. C (covered overhead like a canopy)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XI," how does Shelley show first experiences of the senses? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XI, how does Shelley develop the idea of first experiences of the senses? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XI suggests about first experiences of the senses. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XI to complicate the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of first experiences of the senses responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of first experiences of the senses follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XI and its treatment of first experiences of the senses. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XI as evidence for a larger claim about first experiences of the senses in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of first experiences of the senses. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “incommoded” most nearly mean?

   A. covered as if with a carpet

   B. seize on its way

   C. troubled; inconvenienced

   D. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

2. *“The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest. My sensations had, by this time, become distinct, and my mind received every day additional ideas. My eyes became accustomed to the light, and to perceive objects in their right forms; I distinguished the insect from the herb, and, by degrees, one herb from another. I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XI”?

   A. Delay and dread

   B. The first spark of obsession

   C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. C (troubled; inconvenienced); 2. D (First experiences of the senses)

Lesson 18: Chapter XII

Focus: learning compassion by watching

Teacher only · spoilers

Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.

Background: The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface.

Significance: The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are exhilarated, arbiters, execration, endeared, enhanced. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: ""These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language." In this sentence it means: filled with energy and excitement. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface. Why does this chapter matter? The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to learning compassion by watching? I circle "cultivating", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Setting, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about learning compassion by watching, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes learning compassion by watching. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exhilarated (verb)	filled with energy and excitement	*"These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

arbiters (noun)	people with the power to decide	*I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
execration (noun)	cursing; expressions of hatred	*It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
endeared (verb)	made loved or liked	*The gentle manners and beauty of the cottagers greatly endeared them to me: when they were unhappy, I felt depressed; when they rejoiced, I sympathised in their joys.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enhanced (verb)	increase	*I saw few human beings beside them; and if any other happened to enter the cottage, their harsh manners and rude gait only enhanced to me the superior accomplishments of my friends.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronunciation (noun)	the manner in which someone utters a word	*Their pronunciation was quick; and the words they uttered, not having any apparent connection with visible objects, I was unable to discover any clue by which I could unravel the mystery of their reference.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cultivating (verb)	foster the growth of	*I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
starlight (noun)	the light of the stars	*When they had retired to rest, if there was any moon, or the night was starlight, I went into the woods, and collected my own food and fuel for the cottage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conjectured (verb)	to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds	*I conjectured, therefore, that he found on the paper signs for speech which he understood, and I ardently longed to comprehend these also; but how was that possible, when I did not even understand the sounds for which they stood as signs?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
communicating (verb)	transmit information	*I found that these people possessed a method of communicating their experience and feelings to one another by articulate sounds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does the creature observe?
   A. Villagers in Geneva
   B. The Frankensteins
   C. The De Lacey family
   D. Walton's crew
2. Which family member is blind?
   A. Safie
   B. Agatha
   C. Felix
   D. The old father
3. Why does the creature stop taking their food?
   A. He gets caught
   B. He realizes they are poor
   C. He finds better food
   D. They lock it up
4. What does the creature see in a clear pool?
   A. A fish
   B. The moon only
   C. His own frightening reflection
   D. Victor
5. What does he begin to learn?
   A. Language
   B. Swimming
   C. Chemistry
   D. Music
6. In the line ""These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.", what does "exhilarated" most nearly mean?
   A. cursing; expressions of hatred
   B. made loved or liked
   C. people with the power to decide
   D. filled with energy and excitement
7. In the line "I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.", what does "arbiters" most nearly mean?
   A. filled with energy and excitement
   B. made loved or liked

C. people with the power to decide

D. cursing; expressions of hatred

Answer key: 1. C (The De Lacey family); 2. D (The old father); 3. B (He realizes they are poor); 4. C (His own frightening reflection); 5. A (Language); 6. D (filled with energy and excitement); 7. C (people with the power to decide)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XII," how does Shelley show learning compassion by watching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XII, how does Shelley develop the idea of learning compassion by watching? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XII suggests about learning compassion by watching. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter XII to complicate the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of

learning compassion by watching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of learning compassion by watching follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XII and its treatment of learning compassion by watching. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XII as evidence for a larger claim about learning compassion by watching in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning compassion by watching. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “execration” most nearly mean?

   A. transmit information

   B. the light of the stars

   C. cursing; expressions of hatred

   D. to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds

2. *“I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XII”?

   A. Reading and identity

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. Learning compassion by watching

   D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. C (cursing; expressions of hatred); 2. C (Learning compassion by watching)

Lesson 19: Chapter XIII

Focus: language, knowledge and sorrow

Content note (Orientalist portrayal): Safie and her father ("the Turk") are portrayed through European stereotypes about Muslims and the East. Name the stereotype and ask whose view the narrative takes.
Student preview: This chapter uses stereotypes about people from the Middle East. We will look at them critically.
Suggested language: "How is Safie's father described, and by whom? What stereotype is at work?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge deepens his misery.

Background: Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789.

Significance: Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This chapter uses stereotypes about people from the Middle East. We will look at them critically.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are narrations, recommencing, dissipates, degenerating, disowned. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: ""These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings." In this sentence it means: stories; accounts of events. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789. Why does this chapter matter? Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for allusion.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to language, knowledge and sorrow? I circle "recommencing", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find allusion, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for allusion.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of allusion. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression; he sighed frequently; and once his father paused in his music, and I conjectured by his manner that he enquired the cause of his son's sorrow. Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Allusion, Theme, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about language, knowledge and sorrow, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes language, knowledge and sorrow. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
narrations (noun)	stories; accounts of events	*"These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
recommencing (verb)	starting again	*Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dissipates (verb)	makes disappear; scatters	*They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
degenerating (verb)	grow worse	*I heard of the slothful Asiatics; of the stupendous genius and mental activity of the Grecians; of the wars and wonderful virtue of the early Romans—of their subsequent degenerating—of the decline of that mighty empire; of chivalry, Christianity, and kings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disowned (verb)	prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting	*Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and whom all men disowned?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wondrously (adverb)	extremely well	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hideously (adverb)	in a hideous manner	*I was, besides, endued with a figure hideously deformed and loathsome; I was not even of the same nature as man.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enraptured (verb)	hold spellbound	*The old man appeared enraptured, and said some words, which Agatha endeavoured to explain to Safie, and by which he appeared to wish to express that she bestowed on him the greatest delight by her music.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
braided (verb)	make by braiding or interlacing	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dismount (noun)	the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)	*He assisted her to dismount, and dismissing her guide, conducted her into the cottage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who arrives at the cottage?
   A. Safie
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Clerval
   D. Justine
2. How does Safie's arrival help the creature?
   A. She befriends him
   B. He learns language as she is taught
   C. She brings him chemistry books
   D. She feeds him
3. Which book does Felix read to Safie?
   A. Ruins of Empires
   B. The Bible
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Plutarch's Lives
4. What question does the creature ask himself?
   A. Why is it cold?
   B. What was I?
   C. Who is Walton?
   D. Where is Geneva?
5. How does knowledge affect him?
   A. It cures his loneliness
   B. It increases his sorrow
   C. It makes him rich
   D. It makes him content

6. In the line ““These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.”, what does “narrations” most nearly mean?
   A. makes disappear; scatters
   B. stories; accounts of events
   C. grow worse
   D. starting again
7. In the line “Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.”, what does “recommencing” most nearly mean?
   A. starting again
   B. makes disappear; scatters
   C. stories; accounts of events
   D. grow worse

Answer key: 1. A (Safie); 2. B (He learns language as she is taught); 3. A (Ruins of Empires); 4. B (What was I?); 5. B (It increases his sorrow); 6. B (stories; accounts of events); 7. A (starting again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIII,” how does Shelley show language, knowledge and sorrow? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIII suggests about language, knowledge and sorrow. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XIII to complicate the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of language, knowledge and sorrow follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIII and its treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIII as evidence for a larger claim about language, knowledge and sorrow in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “dissipates” most nearly mean?

   A. the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)

   B. makes disappear; scatters

   C. make by braiding or interlacing

   D. hold spellbound

2. *“It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression; he sighed frequently; and once his father paused in his music, and I conjectured by his manner that*

he enquired the cause of his son's sorrow. Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIII"?

A. Injustice and the burden of silence

B. Isolation in the north

C. The first spark of obsession

D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. B (makes disappear; scatters); 2. D (Language, knowledge and sorrow)

Lesson 20: Chapter XIV

Focus: injustice and exile

Content note (Orientalist portrayal): The De Lacey story continues the stereotyped portrait of Safie's father; contrast it with Safie's own agency.
Student preview: The chapter continues stereotypes about Safie's father.
Suggested language: "Does Safie fit the stereotype the narrator applies to her father?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.

Background: The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world.

Significance: Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: The chapter continues stereotypes about Safie's father.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are facilitated, reiterating, expostulate, passports, noisome. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris." In this sentence it means: made easier. Word histories: "expostulate": From Latin expostulare "to demand urgently, remonstrate," from ex- + postulare "to demand." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world. Why does this chapter matter? Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for plot.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""The name of the old man was De Lacey." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to injustice and exile? I circle "affluence", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find plot, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for plot.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of plot. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"The name of the old man was De Lacey. He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals. His son was bred in the service of his country; and Agatha had ranked with ladies of the highest distinction. A few months before my arrival, they had lived in a large and luxurious city, called Paris, surrounded by friends, and possessed of every enjoyment which virtue, refinement of intellect, or taste, accompanied by a moderate fortune, could afford.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Plot, Characterization, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about injustice and exile, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes injustice and exile. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
facilitated (verb)	made easier	*His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
reiterating (verb)	repeating	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
expostulate (verb)	to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	“expostulate”: From Latin expostulare "to demand urgently, remonstrate," from ex- + postulare "to demand." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/expostulate)
passports (noun)	any authorization to pass or go somewhere	*Felix had procured passports in the name of his father, sister, and himself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
noisome (adjective)	causing or able to cause nausea	*His blind and aged father, and his gentle sister, lay in a noisome dungeon, while he enjoyed the free air, and the society of her whom he loved.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
affluence (noun)	abundant wealth	*He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mandate (noun)	a document giving an official instruction or command	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
spurned (verb)	reject with contempt	*The young girl spoke in high and enthusiastic terms of her mother, who, born in freedom, spurned the bondage to which she was now reduced.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
			Student look-up (not yet verified)

uncontrollable (adjective)	difficult to solve or alleviate	*"Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court.*	
revolved (verb)	turn on or around an axis or a center	*He revolved a thousand plans by which he should be enabled to prolong the deceit until it might be no longer necessary, and secretly to take his daughter with him when he departed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Why were the De Laceys exiled?
   A. They were scientists
   B. They stole money
   C. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
   D. They insulted the king
2. Who betrayed them?
   A. Safie's father
   B. Safie
   C. Agatha
   D. Victor
3. Where did these events take place?
   A. Ingolstadt
   B. Paris
   C. Constantinople
   D. London
4. How does Safie show courage?
   A. She runs a business
   B. She travels alone to find Felix

C. She fights soldiers

D. She becomes a judge

5. What larger pattern does this story show?

A. Wealth guarantees happiness

B. Crime is always punished

C. Travel is safe

D. The virtuous often suffer injustice

6. In the line “His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.”, what does “facilitated” most nearly mean?

A. repeating

B. made easier

C. any authorization to pass or go somewhere

D. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

7. In the line “The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.”, what does “reiterating” most nearly mean?

A. made easier

B. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

C. any authorization to pass or go somewhere

D. repeating

Answer key: 1. C (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape); 2. A (Safie's father); 3. B (Paris); 4. B (She travels alone to find Felix); 5. D (The virtuous often suffer injustice); 6. B (made easier); 7. D (repeating)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIV,” how does Shelley show injustice and exile? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and exile? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter

XIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIV suggests about injustice and exile. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses plot in Chapter XIV to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and exile responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and exile follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIV and its treatment of injustice and exile. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIV as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and exile in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and exile. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*

As used in the text, what does the word "expostulate" most nearly mean?

A. reject with contempt

B. turn on or around an axis or a center

C. difficult to solve or alleviate

D. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

2. *"The name of the old man was De Lacey. He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals. His son was bred in the service of his country; and Agatha had ranked with ladies of the highest distinction. A few months before my arrival, they had lived in a large and luxurious city, called Paris, surrounded by friends, and possessed of every enjoyment which virtue, refinement of intellect, or taste, accompanied by a moderate fortune, could afford.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIV"?

A. First experiences of the senses

B. A letter, a secret and the wedding

C. Injustice and exile

D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

SAT key: 1. D (to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind); 2. C (Injustice and exile)

Lesson 21: Chapter XV

Focus: reading and identity

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him away.

Background: Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation.

Significance: He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are massacring, undeceiving, instigate, unformed, disquisitions. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species." In this sentence it means: killing large numbers of people. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation. Why does this chapter matter? He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for allusion.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to reading and identity? I circle "unformed", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find allusion, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for allusion.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of allusion. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition. I found myself similar, yet at the same time strangely unlike to the beings concerning whom I read, and to whose conversation I was a listener. I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation. My person was hideous, and my stature gigantic? What did this mean? Who was I? What was I? Whence did I come? What was my destination? These questions continually recurred, but I was unable to solve them.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Allusion, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about reading and identity, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes reading and identity. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
massacring (verb)	killing large numbers of people	*I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.*	

			Student look-up (not yet verified)
undeceiving (verb)	showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief	*"The old man paused, and then continued, 'If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
instigate (verb)	to urge on; to provoke	*" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unformed (adjective)	not having form or shape	*I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disquisitions (noun)	an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion	*The disquisitions upon death and suicide were calculated to fill me with wonder.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decipher (verb)	convert code into ordinary language	*At first I had neglected them; but now that I was able to decipher the characters in which they were written, I began to study them with diligence.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
persuades (verb)	win approval or support for	*I am blind, and cannot judge of your countenance, but there is something in your words, which persuades me that you are sincere.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
deprecate (verb)	express strong disapproval of; deplore	*I learned, from the views of social life which it developed, to admire their virtues, and to deprecate the vices of mankind.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
antelope (noun)	a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer	*I could have torn him limb from limb, as the lion rends the antelope.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decreased (verb)	decrease in size, extent, or range	*Their happiness was not decreased by the absence of summer.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Which book is NOT among those he finds?
   A. Robinson Crusoe
   B. Paradise Lost
   C. The Sorrows of Young Werther
   D. Plutarch's Lives
2. What document does he discover in his clothing?
   A. A will
   B. Victor's laboratory journal
   C. A letter from Elizabeth
   D. A map
3. Which character in Milton does he feel most like?
   A. Michael
   B. Satan, the outcast
   C. Gabriel
   D. Eve
4. Why does he choose the blind father first?
   A. He speaks German
   B. He cannot judge by appearance
   C. He is the strongest
   D. He has money
5. What does Felix do when he finds the creature with his father?
   A. Invites him to dinner
   B. Strikes him and drives him away
   C. Calls for a doctor
   D. Shakes his hand
6. In the line “I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.”, what does “massacring” most nearly mean?
   A. to urge on; to provoke
   B. showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief
   C. killing large numbers of people
   D. not having form or shape
7. In the line ““The old man paused, and then continued, ‘If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.”, what does “undeceiving” most nearly mean?
   A. not having form or shape
   B. showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief

C. killing large numbers of people

D. to urge on; to provoke

Answer key: 1. A (Robinson Crusoe); 2. B (Victor's laboratory journal); 3. B (Satan, the outcast); 4. B (He cannot judge by appearance); 5. B (Strikes him and drives him away); 6. C (killing large numbers of people); 7. B (showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XV," how does Shelley show reading and identity? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XV, how does Shelley develop the idea of reading and identity? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XV suggests about reading and identity. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XV to complicate the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of reading and identity responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of reading and identity follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XV and its treatment of reading and identity. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XV as evidence for a larger claim about reading and identity in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of reading and identity. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *“ ‘Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “instigate” most nearly mean?

   A. to urge on; to provoke

   B. decrease in size, extent, or range

   C. express strong disapproval of; deplore

   D. a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer

2. *“As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition. I found myself similar, yet at the same time strangely unlike to the beings concerning whom I read, and to whose conversation I was a listener. I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. ‘The path of my departure was free’; and there was none to lament my annihilation. My person was hideous, and my stature gigantic? What did this mean? Who was I? What was I? Whence did I come? What was my destination? These questions continually recurred, but I was unable to solve them.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XV”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   C. Reading and identity

   D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. A (to urge on; to provoke); 2. C (Reading and identity)

Lesson 22: Chapter XVI

Focus: rejection and the turn to revenge

Content note (murder of a child): The creature recounts strangling William. Keep discussion on responsibility and rejection, not the act itself.
Student preview: The creature describes killing a child.
Suggested language: "What does the creature say led him to this point? Do you accept his account?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.

Background: This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror.

Significance: His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: The creature describes killing a child.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are imprecate, bedewed, underwood, sanguinary, extracting. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!" In this sentence it means: to call down (curses) on. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror. Why does this chapter matter? His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to rejection and the turn to revenge? I circle "obstructed", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find irony, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings. I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness. O! what a miserable night I passed! the cold stars shone in mockery, and the bare trees waved their branches above me: now and then the sweet voice of a bird burst forth amidst the universal stillness. All, save I, were at rest or in enjoyment: I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me; and, finding myself unsympathised with, wished to tear up the trees, spread havoc and destruction around me, and then to have sat down and enjoyed the ruin.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Characterization, Foreshadowing: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about rejection and the turn to revenge, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes rejection and the turn to revenge. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
imprecate (verb)	to call down (curses) on	*Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bedewed (verb)	wet with drops, as of dew or tears	*Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
underwood (noun)	small trees and bushes growing under taller trees	*Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sanguinary (adjective)	accompanied by bloodshed	*Thanks to the lessons of Felix and the sanguinary laws of man, I had learned now to work mischief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
extracting (verb)	remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense	*The ball had entered my shoulder, and I knew not whether it had remained there or passed through; at any rate I had no means of extracting it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
epithets (noun)	a defamatory or abusive word or phrase	*"The child still struggled, and loaded me with epithets which carried despair to my heart; I grasped his throat to silence him, and in a moment he lay dead at my feet.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
obstructed (verb)	hinder or prevent the progress or accomplishment of	*I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
apprehending (verb)	get the meaning of something	*I trembled violently, apprehending some dreadful misfortune.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enkindled (verb)	cause to start burning	*The nearer I approached to your habitation, the more deeply did I feel the spirit of revenge enkindled in my heart.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
imparting (verb)	transmit (knowledge or skills)	*Here, I thought, is one of those whose joy-imparting smiles are bestowed on all but me.*	

			Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?
   A. To Ingolstadt
   B. To London
   C. Toward Geneva
   D. To the North Pole
2. What does the family do after the encounter?
   A. Abandon the cottage
   B. Hire guards
   C. Move into Geneva
   D. Search for him to apologize
3. What does the creature do to the cottage?
   A. Sells it
   B. Repairs it
   C. Burns it
   D. Lives in it with them
4. What happens after he saves a drowning girl?
   A. He is thanked
   B. He is shot
   C. He is adopted
   D. He is hired
5. Why does he kill William?
   A. By accident
   B. He learns the boy is a Frankenstein
   C. For food

D. William attacked him

6. In the line “Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!”, what does “imprecate” most nearly mean?
   A. accompanied by bloodshed
   B. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees
   C. wet with drops, as of dew or tears
   D. to call down (curses) on
7. In the line “Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.”, what does “bedewed” most nearly mean?
   A. wet with drops, as of dew or tears
   B. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees
   C. to call down (curses) on
   D. accompanied by bloodshed

Answer key: 1. C (Toward Geneva); 2. A (Abandon the cottage); 3. C (Burns it); 4. B (He is shot); 5. B (He learns the boy is a Frankenstein); 6. D (to call down (curses) on); 7. A (wet with drops, as of dew or tears)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XVI,” how does Shelley show rejection and the turn to revenge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XVI, how does Shelley develop the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVI suggests about rejection and the turn to revenge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each

(including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XVI to complicate the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XVI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XVI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of rejection and the turn to revenge follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVI and its treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVI as evidence for a larger claim about rejection and the turn to revenge in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underwood” most nearly mean?

   A. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees

   B. cause to start burning

   C. get the meaning of something

   D. transmit (knowledge or skills)

2. *"When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings. I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness. O! what a miserable night I passed! the cold stars shone in mockery, and the bare trees waved their branches above me: now and then the sweet voice of a bird burst forth amidst the universal stillness. All, save I, were at rest or in enjoyment: I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me; and, finding myself unsympathised with, wished to tear up the trees, spread havoc and destruction around me, and then to have sat down and enjoyed the ruin.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVI"?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   B. Obsession and the discovery of life

   C. Delay and dread

   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. A (small trees and bushes growing under taller trees); 2. A (Rejection and the turn to revenge)

Lesson 23: Chapter XVII

Focus: the demand for a companion

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.

Background: Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy.

Significance: This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are insurmountable, concede, trifled, protectors, sickened. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union." In this sentence it means: impossible to overcome. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy. Why does this chapter matter? This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the demand for a companion? I circle "concede", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find theme, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being. This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the demand for a companion, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes the demand for a companion. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
insurmountable (adjective)	impossible to overcome	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
concede (verb)	to grant; to give	*This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

trifled (verb)	treated lightly; toyed with	*I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
protectors (noun)	a person who cares for persons or property	*I thought of the promise of virtues which he had displayed on the opening of his existence, and the subsequent blight of all kindly feeling by the loathing and scorn which his protectors had manifested towards him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sickened (verb)	cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of	*I compassionated him, and sometimes felt a wish to console him; but when I looked upon him, when I saw the filthy mass that moved and talked, my heart sickened, and my feelings were altered to those of horror and hatred.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interchange (noun)	an exchange; a giving and receiving	*"You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
precipices (noun)	a very steep cliff	*His power and threats were not omitted in my calculations: a creature who could exist in the ice-caves of the glaciers, and hide himself from pursuit among the ridges of inaccessible precipices, was a being possessing faculties it would be vain to cope with.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
narrated (verb)	provide commentary for a film, for example	*The latter part of his tale had kindled anew in me the anger that had died away while he narrated his peaceful life among the cottagers, and, as he said this, I could no longer suppress the rage that burned within me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
barriers (noun)	a structure or object that impedes free movement	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
persevere (verb)	be persistent, refuse to stop	*How can you, who long for the love and sympathy of man, persevere in this exile?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. What does the creature demand?
   A. A female companion
   B. Victor's death
   C. To live in Geneva
   D. Money
2. Where does he promise to go?
   A. London
   B. Italy
   C. The wilds of South America
   D. The North Pole
3. Why does Victor agree?
   A. He is bribed
   B. He feels compassion and fear
   C. Elizabeth asks him
   D. He is curious
4. What theme does the request highlight?
   A. The need for companionship
   B. Wealth
   C. Love of fame
   D. Religion
5. What kind of moment is this in the plot?
   A. An ending
   B. A flashback only
   C. A turning point bargain
   D. A comic interlude
6. In the line “But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.”, what does “insurmountable” most nearly mean?
   A. treated lightly; toyed with
   B. to grant; to give
   C. a person who cares for persons or property
   D. impossible to overcome
7. In the line “This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede.””, what does “concede” most nearly mean?
   A. to grant; to give
   B. treated lightly; toyed with
   C. impossible to overcome
   D. a person who cares for persons or property

Answer key: 1. A (A female companion); 2. C (The wilds of South America); 3. B (He feels compassion and fear); 4. A (The need for companionship); 5. C (A turning point bargain); 6. D (impossible to overcome); 7. A (to grant; to give)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XVII," how does Shelley show the demand for a companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XVII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the demand for a companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVII suggests about the demand for a companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses theme in Chapter XVII to complicate the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XVII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the demand for a companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XVII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the

demand for a companion follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVII and its treatment of the demand for a companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVII as evidence for a larger claim about the demand for a companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the demand for a companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “trifled” most nearly mean?

   A. a structure or object that impedes free movement

   B. treated lightly; toyed with

   C. be persistent, refuse to stop

   D. provide commentary for a film, for example

2. *“You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being. This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVII”?

   A. Confrontation between creator and creation

   B. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   C. The demand for a companion

   D. Isolation in the north

SAT key: 1. B (treated lightly; toyed with); 2. C (The demand for a companion)

Lesson 24: Chapter XVIII

Focus: delay and dread

Teacher only · spoilers

Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.

Background: The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing.

Significance: Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are eradicating, enfranchised, sedulous, meandering, dilatory. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine." In this sentence it means: removing completely. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing. Why does this chapter matter? Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to delay and dread? I circle "enfranchised", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return. My father's age rendered him extremely averse to delay. For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Setting, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about delay and dread, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes delay and dread. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
eradicating (verb)	removing completely	*My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.	
enfranchised (verb)	set free	*For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sedulous (adjective)	careful and persistent	*It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
meandering (adjective)	winding; following a curving course	*In one spot you view rugged hills, ruined castles overlooking tremendous precipices, with the dark Rhine rushing beneath; and, on the sudden turn of a promontory, flourishing vineyards, with green sloping banks, and a meandering river, and populous towns occupy the scene.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dilatory (adjective)	slow; tending to delay	*The latter method of obtaining the desired intelligence was dilatory and unsatisfactory: besides, I had an insurmountable aversion to the idea of engaging myself in my loathsome task in my father's house, while in habits of familiar intercourse with those I loved.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inhabits (verb)	inhabit or live in; be an inhabitant of	*Oh, surely, the spirit that inhabits and guards this place has a soul more in harmony with man, than those who pile the glacier, or retire to the inaccessible peaks of the mountains of our own country."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inroads (noun)	an encroachment or intrusion	*My journey had been my own suggestion, and Elizabeth, therefore, acquiesced: but she was filled with disquiet at the idea of my suffering, away from her, the inroads of misery and grief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
harrowing (adjective)	deeply distressing	*I was aware also that I should often lose all self-command, all capacity of hiding the harrowing sensations that would possess me during the progress of my unearthly occupation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unexampled (adjective)	never seen before; unequaled	*Pardon this gush of sorrow; these ineffectual words are but a slight tribute to the unexampled worth of Henry, but they soothe my heart, overflowing with the anguish which his remembrance creates.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
variegated (adjective)	varied in color or appearance	*This part of the Rhine, indeed, presents a singularly variegated landscape.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Victor travel to England?
   A. To meet Walton
   B. To study law
   C. To create the female in secret
   D. To visit his mother
2. Who travels with him?
   A. Justine
   B. Clerval
   C. Ernest
   D. Elizabeth
3. What river do they travel along?
   A. The Seine
   B. The Rhine
   C. The Danube
   D. The Thames
4. What does Victor's father want to know?
   A. Whether he is ill
   B. Where the creature is
   C. Whether Victor loves someone else
   D. If he needs money
5. How is Clerval described in this chapter?
   A. Gloomy
   B. Angry
   C. Ill
   D. Joyful and alive to nature
6. In the line “My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.”, what does “eradicating” most nearly mean?
   A. careful and persistent
   B. removing completely
   C. set free
   D. winding; following a curving course

7. In the line “For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.”, what does “enfranchised” most nearly mean?

   A. set free

   B. careful and persistent

   C. removing completely

   D. winding; following a curving course

Answer key: 1. C (To create the female in secret); 2. B (Clerval); 3. B (The Rhine); 4. C (Whether Victor loves someone else); 5. D (Joyful and alive to nature); 6. B (removing completely); 7. A (set free)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XVIII,” how does Shelley show delay and dread? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XVIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of delay and dread? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVIII suggests about delay and dread. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XVIII to complicate the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XVIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of delay and dread responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XVIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of delay and dread follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVIII and its treatment of delay and dread. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVIII as evidence for a larger claim about delay and dread in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of delay and dread. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sedulous" most nearly mean?

   A. careful and persistent

   B. varied in color or appearance

   C. never seen before; unequaled

   D. deeply distressing

2. *To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return. My father's age rendered him extremely averse to delay. For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVIII"?

   A. Confrontation between creator and creation

   B. Delay and dread

   C. Confidence before danger

D. Reading and identity

SAT key: 1. A (careful and persistent); 2. B (Delay and dread)

Lesson 25: Chapter XIX

Focus: isolation in the north

Teacher only · spoilers

In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.

Background: Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned.

Significance: The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are expedite, roarings, debasing, oatmeal, scraggy. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion." In this sentence it means: to speed up; to hasten. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned. Why does this chapter matter? The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to isolation in the north? I circle "highlands", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find setting, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for setting.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February. We accordingly determined to commence our journey towards the north at the expiration of another month. In this expedition we did not intend to follow the great road to Edinburgh, but to visit Windsor, Oxford, Matlock, and the Cumberland lakes, resolving to arrive at the completion of this tour about the end of July. I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Tone / mood, Foreshadowing: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about isolation in the north, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes isolation in the north. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
expedite (verb)	to speed up; to hasten	*Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

roarings (noun)	loud, deep sounds	*Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
debasing (adjective)	degrading; lowering in dignity	*For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oatmeal (noun)	porridge made of rolled oats	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scraggy (adjective)	being very thin	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
engages (verb)	holds (attention)	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intermixed (verb)	combine into one	*I looked towards its completion with a tremulous and eager hope, which I dared not trust myself to question, but which was intermixed with obscure forebodings of evil, that made my heart sicken in my bosom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
highlands (noun)	hilly or mountainous country	*I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
forsakes (verb)	gives up; abandons	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
remonstrate (verb)	argue in protest or opposition	*Henry wished to dissuade me; but, seeing me bent on this plan, ceased to remonstrate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Victor work on the second creature?
   A. London
   B. A remote island in the Orkneys
   C. Oxford
   D. Edinburgh University
2. Who does he leave behind?
   A. Clerval
   B. His father
   C. Walton
   D. Elizabeth
3. What is Victor's mood while working?
   A. Excited
   B. Hopeful
   C. Miserable and filled with dread
   D. Peaceful
4. Which English city prompts thoughts of history?
   A. Bath
   B. Oxford
   C. Bristol
   D. Manchester
5. What does the desolate setting mirror?
   A. The creature's joy
   B. Elizabeth's beauty
   C. Victor's inner isolation
   D. Clerval's happiness
6. In the line “Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.”, what does “expedite” most nearly mean?
   A. degrading; lowering in dignity
   B. porridge made of rolled oats
   C. loud, deep sounds
   D. to speed up; to hasten
7. In the line “Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.”, what does “roarings” most nearly mean?
   A. porridge made of rolled oats
   B. degrading; lowering in dignity
   C. to speed up; to hasten
   D. loud, deep sounds

Answer key: 1. B (A remote island in the Orkneys); 2. A (Clerval); 3. C (Miserable and filled with dread); 4. B (Oxford); 5. C (Victor's inner isolation); 6. D (to speed up; to hasten); 7. D (loud, deep sounds)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIX,” how does Shelley show isolation in the north? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XIX, how does Shelley develop the idea of isolation in the north? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIX suggests about isolation in the north. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter XIX to complicate the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XIX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of isolation in the north responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XIX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of isolation in the north follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIX and its treatment of isolation in the north. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIX as evidence for a larger claim about isolation in the north in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of isolation in the north. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “debasing” most nearly mean?

   A. degrading; lowering in dignity

   B. gives up; abandons

   C. argue in protest or opposition

   D. hilly or mountainous country

2. *We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February. We accordingly determined to commence our journey towards the north at the expiration of another month. In this expedition we did not intend to follow the great road to Edinburgh, but to visit Windsor, Oxford, Matlock, and the Cumberland lakes, resolving to arrive at the completion of this tour about the end of July. I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIX”?

   A. Learning compassion by watching

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. The final reckoning

   D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. A (degrading; lowering in dignity); 2. B (Isolation in the north)

Lesson 26: Chapter XX

Focus: destroying the companion

Teacher only · spoilers

Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.

Background: Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population.

Significance: Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are specked, wiliness, slenderly, debility, buffeted. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another." In this sentence it means: dotted; spotted. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to destroying the companion? I circle "loitered", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement. A ghastly grin wrinkled his lips as he gazed on me, where I sat fulfilling the task which he had allotted to me. Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Foreshadowing, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about destroying the companion, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes destroying the companion. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
specked (verb)	dotted; spotted	*A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

wiliness (noun)	cunning; craftiness	*I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
slenderly (adverb)	only slightly; poorly	*I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
debility (noun)	the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)	*As I was in a state of extreme debility, I resolved to sail directly towards the town, as a place where I could most easily procure nourishment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
buffeted (verb)	struck again and again	*I might be driven into the wide Atlantic, and feel all the tortures of starvation, or be swallowed up in the immeasurable waters that roared and buffeted around me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
paddling (verb)	propel with a paddle	*I felt the silence, although I was hardly conscious of its extreme profundity, until my ear was suddenly arrested by the paddling of oars near the shore, and a person landed close to my house.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
irresolution (noun)	doubt concerning two or more possible alternatives or courses of action	*"The hour of my irresolution is past, and the period of your power is arrived.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
construed (verb)	make sense of; assign a meaning to	*I was ready to sink from fatigue and hunger; but, being surrounded by a crowd, I thought it politic to rouse all my strength, that no physical debility might be construed into apprehension or conscious guilt.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mutable (adjective)	capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature	*How mutable are our feelings, and how strange is that clinging love we have of life even in the excess of misery!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
loitered (verb)	lingered; hung about	*Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Victor destroy the female?
   A. He runs out of materials
   B. He fears a race of devils
   C. The creature asks him
   D. She is finished and dangerous
2. What does the creature threaten?
   A. To leave forever
   B. To kill Walton
   C. To be with Victor on his wedding night
   D. To burn Geneva
3. Where does Victor land after drifting at sea?
   A. Iceland
   B. France
   C. Ireland
   D. Norway
4. What happens when he lands?
   A. He marries
   B. He is welcomed
   C. He is arrested for murder
   D. He meets Walton
5. How might readers view his decision?
   A. As accidental
   B. As courage or as another abandonment
   C. As unimportant
   D. As purely comic
6. In the line "A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.", what does "specked" most nearly mean?
   A. the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)
   B. dotted; spotted
   C. only slightly; poorly
   D. cunning; craftiness
7. In the line "I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.", what does "wiliness" most nearly mean?
   A. only slightly; poorly
   B. cunning; craftiness
   C. dotted; spotted

D. the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)

Answer key: 1. B (He fears a race of devils); 2. C (To be with Victor on his wedding night); 3. C (Ireland); 4. C (He is arrested for murder); 5. B (As courage or as another abandonment); 6. B (dotted; spotted); 7. B (cunning; craftiness)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XX,” how does Shelley show destroying the companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XX, how does Shelley develop the idea of destroying the companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XX suggests about destroying the companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses conflict in Chapter XX to complicate the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of destroying the companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of destroying

the companion follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XX and its treatment of destroying the companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XX as evidence for a larger claim about destroying the companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of destroying the companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “slenderly” most nearly mean?

   A. only slightly; poorly

   B. capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature

   C. lingered; hung about

   D. make sense of; assign a meaning to

2. *I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement. A ghastly grin wrinkled his lips as he gazed on me, where I sat fulfilling the task which he had allotted to me. Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XX”?

   A. The meeting of two ambitious men

   B. The first death and growing guilt

   C. Destroying the companion

   D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. A (only slightly; poorly); 2. C (Destroying the companion)

Lesson 27: Chapter XXI

Focus: grief, prison and return

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.

Background: Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts.

Significance: Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are turnkeys, gaolers, assizes, vexations, retrospect. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon." In this sentence it means: jailers who keep the keys. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts. Why does this chapter matter? Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to grief, prison and return? I circle "turnkeys", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find irony, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon. It was morning, I remember, when I thus awoke to understanding: I had forgotten the particulars of what had happened, and only felt as if some great misfortune had suddenly overwhelmed me; but when I looked around, and saw the barred windows, and the squalidness of the room in which I was, all flashed across my memory, and I groaned bitterly.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Plot, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about grief, prison and return, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes grief, prison and return. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
turnkeys (noun)	jailers who keep the keys	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.	
gaolers (noun)	jailers (British spelling)	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assizes (noun)	regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)	*The season of the assizes approached.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vexations (noun)	annoyances; worries	*My father was enraptured on finding me freed from the vexations of a criminal charge, that I was again allowed to breathe the fresh atmosphere, and permitted to return to my native country.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retrospect (noun)	contemplation of things past	*Kirwin said this, notwithstanding the agitation I endured on this retrospect of my sufferings, I also felt considerable surprise at the knowledge he seemed to possess concerning me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hangman (noun)	an executioner who hangs the condemned person	*Who could be interested in the fate of a murderer, but the hangman who would gain his fee?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
liberated (verb)	set free	*The grand jury rejected the bill, on its being proved that I was on the Orkney Islands at the hour the body of my friend was found; and a fortnight after my removal I was liberated from prison.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
residing (verb)	make one's home in a particular place or community	*I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while residing with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
laudanum (noun)	narcotic consisting of an alcohol solution of opium or any preparation in which opium is the main ingredient	*Ever since my recovery from the fever, I had been in the custom of taking every night a small quantity of laudanum; for it was by means of this drug only that I was enabled to gain the rest necessary for the preservation of life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decides (verb)	reach, make, or come to a decision about something	*I was spared the disgrace of appearing publicly as a criminal, as the case was not brought before the court that decides on life and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Who is the murdered man?
   A. Felix
   B. Mr. Kirwin
   C. Henry Clerval
   D. William
2. How long does Victor lie ill in prison?
   A. One week
   B. About two months
   C. One day
   D. Five years
3. Who is kind to Victor in Ireland?
   A. Safie
   B. Mr. Kirwin
   C. Felix
   D. Krempe
4. Who comes to bring Victor home?
   A. Walton
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Ernest
   D. His father
5. What is ironic about Victor being accused?
   A. He was in Geneva
   B. He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act
   C. He confesses
   D. He likes jail
6. In the line “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.”, what does “turnkeys” most nearly mean?
   A. jailers (British spelling)
   B. jailers who keep the keys
   C. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)
   D. annoyances; worries

7. In the line “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.”, what does “gaolers” most nearly mean?
   A. annoyances; worries
   B. jailers who keep the keys
   C. jailers (British spelling)
   D. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

Answer key: 1. C (Henry Clerval); 2. B (About two months); 3. B (Mr. Kirwin); 4. D (His father); 5. B (He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act); 6. B (jailers who keep the keys); 7. C (jailers (British spelling))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXI,” how does Shelley show grief, prison and return? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXI, how does Shelley develop the idea of grief, prison and return? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXI suggests about grief, prison and return. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XXI to complicate the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of grief, prison and return responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of grief, prison and return follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXI and its treatment of grief, prison and return. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXI as evidence for a larger claim about grief, prison and return in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of grief, prison and return. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The season of the assizes approached.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “assizes” most nearly mean?

   A. narcotic consisting of an alcohol solution of opium or any preparation in which opium is the main ingredient

   B. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

   C. reach, make, or come to a decision about something

   D. make one's home in a particular place or community

2. *But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon. It was morning, I remember, when I thus awoke to understanding: I had forgotten the particulars of what had happened, and only felt as if some great misfortune had suddenly overwhelmed me; but when I looked around, and saw the barred windows, and the squalidness of the room in which I was, all flashed across my memory, and I groaned bitterly.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXI”?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. Grief, prison and return

C. A privileged childhood and family love

D. Injustice and exile

SAT key: 1. B (regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)); 2. B (Grief, prison and return)

Lesson 28: Chapter XXII

Focus: a letter, a secret and the wedding

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the creature's threat ("I will be with you on your wedding night"), he assumes he himself is the target and carries pistols and a dagger. Back in Geneva the wedding is fixed; after the ceremony the couple sail across the lake to spend the night at Evian, and the chapter ends as they near the shore at sunset.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance.

Significance: Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are overtaxed, unchained, obliterate, amphitheatre, playmate. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey." In this sentence it means: strained by asking too much of. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance. Why does this chapter matter? Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to a letter, a secret and the wedding? I circle "futility", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair. Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Irony, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about a letter, a secret and the wedding, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes a letter, a secret and the wedding. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overtaxed (verb)	strained by asking too much of	*I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unchained (verb)	set free from chains; released	*I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
obliterate (verb)	to erase completely	*He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
amphitheatre (noun)	a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)	*The Alps here come closer to the lake, and we approached the amphitheatre of mountains which forms its eastern boundary.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
playmate (noun)	a companion at play	*Victor, be assured that your cousin and playmate has too sincere a love for you not to be made miserable by this supposition.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
centred (verb)	focused; concentrated (British spelling)	*I said, "little happiness remains for us on earth; yet all that I may one day enjoy is centred in you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
futility (noun)	uselessness as a consequence of having no practical result	*Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
penniless (adjective)	not having enough money to pay for necessities	*Alas! what freedom? such as the peasant enjoys when his family have been massacred before his eyes, his cottage burnt, his lands laid waste, and he is turned adrift, homeless, penniless, and alone, but free.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conduce (verb)	be conducive to	*I resolved, therefore, that if my immediate union with my cousin would conduce either to hers or my father's happiness, my adversary's designs against my life should not retard it a single hour.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
menaces (noun)	something that is a source of danger	*My destruction might indeed arrive a few months sooner; but if my torturer should suspect that I postponed it, influenced by his menaces, he would surely find other, and perhaps more dreadful means of revenge.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. His father
   C. Walton
   D. Clerval
2. What does Victor promise to tell Elizabeth the day after the wedding?
   A. The name of a rival
   B. His dreadful secret
   C. Why he left Ingolstadt
   D. Where he hid the journal
3. Whom does Victor believe the creature will attack on the wedding night?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Himself
   C. Ernest
   D. His father
4. How do Victor and Elizabeth travel after the ceremony?
   A. On foot to Chamounix
   B. By boat across the lake to Evian
   C. By coach to Paris
   D. By ship to England
5. What does Victor carry to protect himself?
   A. A letter of safe conduct
   B. A sword
   C. Pistols and a dagger
   D. Nothing
6. In the line “I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.”, what does “overtaxed” most nearly mean?
   A. to erase completely
   B. strained by asking too much of

C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

D. set free from chains; released

7. In the line “I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.”, what does “unchained” most nearly mean?

A. to erase completely

B. set free from chains; released

C. strained by asking too much of

D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

Answer key: 1. B (His father); 2. B (His dreadful secret); 3. B (Himself); 4. B (By boat across the lake to Evian); 5. C (Pistols and a dagger); 6. B (strained by asking too much of); 7. B (set free from chains; released)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXII,” how does Shelley show a letter, a secret and the wedding? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXII, how does Shelley develop the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXII suggests about a letter, a secret and the wedding. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXII to complicate the reader's

understanding of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a letter, a secret and the wedding follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXII and its treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXII as evidence for a larger claim about a letter, a secret and the wedding in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “obliterate” most nearly mean?

   A. to erase completely

   B. something that is a source of danger

   C. be conducive to

   D. not having enough money to pay for necessities

2. *My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair. Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXII”?

   A. Injustice and exile

   B. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   C. A letter, a secret and the wedding

D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. A (to erase completely); 2. C (A letter, a secret and the wedding)

Lesson 29: Chapter XXIII

Focus: the wedding night and its catastrophe

Content note (murder, grief): Elizabeth is murdered on her wedding night and Victor's father dies of grief. Allow students space; do not ask for vivid description.
Student preview: This chapter includes a murder and a death from grief.
Suggested language: "How does loss change Victor's purpose?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within days. Victor is confined for months as a madman; on release he tells his story to a Genevan magistrate, who listens with half-belief but doubts anything can be done, and Victor vows to pursue the creature himself.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good.

Significance: The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This chapter includes a murder and a death from grief.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are deviating, inspecting, intimidated, seizure, maddening. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation." In this sentence it means: turning aside; straying. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good. Why does this chapter matter? The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the wedding night and its catastrophe? I circle "inspecting", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find foreshadowing, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary. But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream. It came from the room into which Elizabeth had retired. As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs. This state lasted but for an instant; the scream was repeated, and I rushed into the room.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Irony, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the wedding night and its catastrophe, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the wedding night and its catastrophe. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
deviating (verb)	turning aside; straying	*I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inspecting (verb)	looking at closely; examining	*She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intimidated (verb)	frightened; made fearful	*As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—"You are mistaken," said he, "I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
seizure (noun)	capture; being taken by force	*When I had concluded my narration, I said, "This is the being whom I accuse, and for whose seizure and punishment I call upon you to exert your whole power.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
maddening (adjective)	driving one wild	*I was possessed by a maddening rage when I thought of him, and desired and ardently prayed that I might have him within my grasp to wreak a great and signal revenge on his cursed head.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
auditor (noun)	someone who listens attentively	*This address caused a considerable change in the physiognomy of my own auditor.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tingling (verb)	prickling or stinging slightly	*As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intervened (verb)	get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or	*But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to*	

	through force or threat of force	*prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
torrents (noun)	a heavy rain	*There were no horses to be procured, and I must return by the lake; but the wind was unfavourable, and the rain fell in torrents.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conjured (verb)	summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic	*After passing several hours, we returned hopeless, most of my companions believing it to have been a form conjured up by my fancy.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Elizabeth's murder take place?
   A. On the boat
   B. At the inn at Evian
   C. In Paris
   D. In Geneva
2. What does Victor see at the window after finding Elizabeth?
   A. The creature, grinning
   B. Clerval's ghost
   C. A magistrate
   D. His father
3. How does Victor's father die?
   A. At sea
   B. Murdered by the creature
   C. Of grief, soon after the news
   D. In a duel
4. What happens to Victor after his father's death?
   A. He marries again
   B. He is confined as a madman for months

C. He is tried for murder

D. He sails to the Arctic at once

5. How does the Genevan magistrate respond to Victor's story?

A. With half-belief, doubting anything can be done

B. With laughter

C. With full belief and action

D. By arresting Victor

6. In the line “I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.”, what does “deviating” most nearly mean?

A. turning aside; straying

B. frightened; made fearful

C. capture; being taken by force

D. looking at closely; examining

7. In the line “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.”, what does “inspecting” most nearly mean?

A. frightened; made fearful

B. turning aside; straying

C. capture; being taken by force

D. looking at closely; examining

Answer key: 1. B (At the inn at Evian); 2. A (The creature, grinning); 3. C (Of grief, soon after the news); 4. B (He is confined as a madman for months); 5. A (With half-belief, doubting anything can be done); 6. A (turning aside; straying); 7. D (looking at closely; examining)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXIII,” how does Shelley show the wedding night and its catastrophe? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIII suggests about the wedding night and its catastrophe. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXIII to complicate the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the wedding night and its catastrophe follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIII and its treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIII as evidence for a larger claim about the wedding night and its catastrophe in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—"You are mistaken," said he, "I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "intimidated" most nearly mean?

   A. frightened; made fearful

   B. a heavy rain

   C. summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic

   D. get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force

2. *She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary. But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream. It came from the room into which Elizabeth had retired. As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs. This state lasted but for an instant; the scream was repeated, and I rushed into the room.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXIII"?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. First experiences of the senses

   C. Delay and dread

   D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. A (frightened; made fearful); 2. D (The wedding night and its catastrophe)

Lesson 30: Chapter XXIV

Focus: the final reckoning

Content note (suicide (planned self-destruction), the word "abortion"): The creature vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre, and calls himself "an abortion" (meaning a failed or monstrous creation). Use the safe-messaging script; the word is not on the vocabulary list.
Student preview: The ending includes a character planning to end his own life. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "What does the creature's final speech claim about responsibility?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.

Background: Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop.

Significance: The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: The ending includes a character planning to end his own life. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are curdles, disencumbered, execrate, congeal, glimmers. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?" In this sentence it means: thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold. Word histories: "curdles": Frequentative of curd (v.) "to form curds"; English, not from Latin cura. For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop. Why does this chapter matter? The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the final reckoning? I circle "tardily", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find point of view, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for point of view.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know. Sometimes, indeed, he left marks in writing on the barks of the trees, or cut in stone, that guided me, and instigated my fury. "My reign is not yet over," (these words were legible in one of these inscriptions;) "you live, and my power is complete. Follow me; I seek the everlasting ices of the north, where you will feel the misery of cold and frost, to which I am impassive. You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed. Come on, my enemy; we have yet to wrestle for our lives; but many hard and miserable hours must you endure until that period shall arrive."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Theme, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the final reckoning, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the final reckoning. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
curdles (verb)	thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	"curdles": Frequentative of curd (v.) "to form curds"; English, not from Latin cura. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/curdle)
disencumbered (verb)	freed from a burden	*But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
execrate (verb)	to curse; to hate	*Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
congeal (verb)	to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
glimmers (verb)	shines faintly	*Frankenstein has daily declined in health: a feverish fire still glimmers in his eyes; but he is exhausted, and, when suddenly roused to any exertion, he speedily sinks again into apparent lifelessness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scaring (adjective)	frightening	*I approached this tremendous being; I dared not again raise my eyes to his face, there was something so scaring and unearthly in his ugliness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tardily (adverb)	slowly; late	*You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed.*	"tardily": tardy + -ly; tardy is from Old French tardif, from Latin tardus "slow." (Not from ardere "to burn.")

			(Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/tardy)
composes (verb)	calms; settles	*Oh, no! the only joy that he can now know will be when he composes his shattered spirit to peace and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
modulated (verb)	adjusted in tone	*He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different feelings expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty design and heroism, that can you wonder that these men were moved?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
participated (verb)	shared with others	*When I first sought it, it was the love of virtue, the feelings of happiness and affection with which my whole being overflowed, that I wished to be participated.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What do Walton's crew demand?
   A. More pay
   B. To find the creature
   C. To turn back south
   D. To land in Russia
2. How does Walton respond?
   A. He punishes them
   B. He leaves the ship
   C. He agrees to return
   D. He refuses
3. What happens to Victor?
   A. He returns to Geneva
   B. He marries again

C. He kills the creature

D. He dies on the ship

4. What does the creature plan to do?

A. Destroy himself on a funeral pyre

B. Rule the Arctic

C. Create a mate

D. Go to London

5. Whose voice ends the story?

A. Elizabeth's

B. Victor's

C. Clerval's

D. Walton's, recording the creature's departure

6. In the line “You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?”, what does “curdles” most nearly mean?

A. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)

B. thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold

C. freed from a burden

D. to curse; to hate

7. In the line “But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour’s rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.”, what does “disencumbered” most nearly mean?

A. to curse; to hate

B. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)

C. thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold

D. freed from a burden

Answer key: 1. C (To turn back south); 2. C (He agrees to return); 3. D (He dies on the ship); 4. A (Destroy himself on a funeral pyre); 5. D (Walton's, recording the creature's departure); 6. B (thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold); 7. D (freed from a burden)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXIV,” how does Shelley show the final reckoning? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the final reckoning? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIV suggests about the final reckoning. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XXIV to complicate the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the final reckoning responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the final reckoning follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIV and its treatment of the final reckoning. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIV as evidence for a larger claim about the final reckoning in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the final reckoning. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic,

feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "execrate" most nearly mean?

   A. shared with others
   B. to curse; to hate
   C. adjusted in tone
   D. calms; settles

2. *What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know. Sometimes, indeed, he left marks in writing on the barks of the trees, or cut in stone, that guided me, and instigated my fury. "My reign is not yet over," (these words were legible in one of these inscriptions;) "you live, and my power is complete. Follow me; I seek the everlasting ices of the north, where you will feel the misery of cold and frost, to which I am impassive. You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed. Come on, my enemy; we have yet to wrestle for our lives; but many hard and miserable hours must you endure until that period shall arrive."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXIV"?

   A. Reading and identity
   B. A privileged childhood and family love
   C. Horror at the moment of creation
   D. The final reckoning

SAT key: 1. B (to curse; to hate); 2. D (The final reckoning)

Whole-book test

Frankenstein: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?
   A. In London
   B. In Venice
   C. On a ship to the Arctic
   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?
   A. Isaac Newton
   B. Galileo
   C. Humphry Davy
   D. Dr. Darwin
3. To whom is Walton writing?
   A. His sister, Margaret Saville
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. A ship's captain
   D. His father
4. What does Walton say he lacks most?
   A. A friend who shares his feelings
   B. A ship
   C. Money for the voyage
   D. Maps of the Arctic
5. How does Walton feel in Letter III?
   A. Ill and weak
   B. Confident and determined
   C. Ready to turn back
   D. Terrified
6. What does the crew first see on the ice?
   A. A polar bear
   B. A lost ship
   C. A gigantic figure on a dog sled
   D. A fire
7. Where is Victor's family from?
   A. Paris

B. Naples

C. London

D. Geneva

8. Which author first fascinates Victor?

A. Cornelius Agrippa

B. Homer

C. Isaac Newton

D. Shakespeare

9. How does Victor's mother die?

A. A carriage accident

B. Drowning

C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth

D. Old age

10. What does Victor discover?

A. A route to the pole

B. A cure for fever

C. A new planet

D. The cause of generation and life

11. What month does the creature come to life?

A. March

B. December

C. November

D. June

12. Who writes to Victor during his recovery?

A. Walton

B. His mother

C. Krempe

D. Elizabeth

13. Who has been murdered?

A. Alphonse

B. Elizabeth

C. Clerval

D. William, Victor's youngest brother

14. What happens at Justine's trial?

A. She is freed

B. She escapes

C. She is convicted and condemned

D. The trial is cancelled

15. What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate?
    A. Ending his own life
    B. Becoming a monk
    C. Marrying at once
    D. Moving to England
16. Where does Victor meet the creature?
    A. In Geneva
    B. In a church
    C. On the glacier at Montanvert
    D. On Walton's ship
17. Who narrates this chapter?
    A. Elizabeth
    B. Walton
    C. The creature
    D. Victor
18. Whom does the creature observe?
    A. Villagers in Geneva
    B. The Frankensteins
    C. The De Lacey family
    D. Walton's crew
19. Who arrives at the cottage?
    A. Safie
    B. Elizabeth
    C. Clerval
    D. Justine
20. Why were the De Laceys exiled?
    A. They were scientists
    B. They stole money
    C. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
    D. They insulted the king
21. Which book is NOT among those he finds?
    A. Robinson Crusoe
    B. Paradise Lost
    C. The Sorrows of Young Werther
    D. Plutarch's Lives
22. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?
    A. To Ingolstadt
    B. To London
    C. Toward Geneva

D. To the North Pole

23. What does the creature demand?
    A. A female companion
    B. Victor's death
    C. To live in Geneva
    D. Money
24. Why does Victor travel to England?
    A. To meet Walton
    B. To study law
    C. To create the female in secret
    D. To visit his mother
25. Where does Victor work on the second creature?
    A. London
    B. A remote island in the Orkneys
    C. Oxford
    D. Edinburgh University
26. Why does Victor destroy the female?
    A. He runs out of materials
    B. He fears a race of devils
    C. The creature asks him
    D. She is finished and dangerous
27. Who is the murdered man?
    A. Felix
    B. Mr. Kirwin
    C. Henry Clerval
    D. William
28. Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there?
    A. Elizabeth
    B. His father
    C. Walton
    D. Clerval
29. Where does Elizabeth's murder take place?
    A. On the boat
    B. At the inn at Evian
    C. In Paris
    D. In Geneva
30. What do Walton's crew demand?
    A. More pay
    B. To find the creature

C. To turn back south

D. To land in Russia

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the costs of unchecked ambition develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how creation and responsibility develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how isolation and the need for companionship develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the costs of unchecked ambition, creation and responsibility, isolation and the need for companionship, nature versus nurture, the sublime power of nature) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. D (Near Geneva, Switzerland); 2. D (Dr. Darwin); 3. A (His sister, Margaret Saville); 4. A (A friend who shares his feelings); 5. B (Confident and determined); 6. C (A gigantic figure on a dog sled); 7. D (Geneva); 8. A (Cornelius Agrippa); 9. C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth); 10. D (The cause of generation and life); 11. C (November); 12. D (Elizabeth); 13. D (William, Victor's youngest brother); 14. C (She is convicted and condemned); 15. A (Ending his own life); 16. C (On the glacier at Montanvert); 17. C (The creature); 18. C (The De Lacey family); 19. A (Safie); 20. C (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape); 21. A (Robinson Crusoe); 22. C (Toward Geneva); 23. A (A female companion); 24. C (To create the female in secret); 25. B (A remote island in the Orkneys); 26. B (He fears a race of devils); 27. C (Henry Clerval); 28. B (His father); 29. B (At the inn at Evian); 30. C (To turn back south)

Essay assignments

Essay: The costs of unchecked ambition

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the costs of unchecked ambition. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the costs of unchecked ambition. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the costs of unchecked ambition, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the costs of unchecked ambition in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Name your

critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Creation and responsibility

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about creation and responsibility. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of creation and responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of creation and responsibility, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of creation and responsibility in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Isolation and the need for companionship

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about isolation and the need for companionship. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of isolation and the need for companionship. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of isolation and the need for companionship, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of isolation and the need for companionship in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Nature versus nurture

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about nature versus nurture. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature versus nurture. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of nature versus nurture, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of nature versus nurture in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature versus nurture in

Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The sublime power of nature

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the sublime power of nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the sublime power of nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the sublime power of nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

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College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.